

The Remote Closer's Handbook

A complete student study textbook for Nigerians who want to become professional remote sales closers for AI, SaaS and technology companies — built on the DSS Decision Tree Framework, in the spirit of Brian Choi's Real Sales System, with 26 deep lessons, role play scripts, case studies and drills.

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Welcome, Future Closer

This book has one job. It takes a person who has never held a sales role, who may be a fresh graduate in Yaba, a corps member in Kaduna, a schoolteacher in Uyo or a shop assistant in Aba, and walks that person step by step to the point where a company can trust them with a live call and a real customer. Nothing in these pages requires a special background. You do not need a degree in marketing, you do not need to be loud, and you do not need to be born with what people call the gift of the gab. You need a method, a lot of practice, and the discipline to keep showing up on the days when you do not feel like it. The method is in this book. The practice is your side of the bargain.

A closer is the person who speaks with a prospect after that prospect has already shown interest, finds out whether the product truly fits, explains the solution, deals with the doubts, and helps the person decide. In many technology companies the closer works from home, often serving customers in another country, and is paid mostly or entirely by commission. That last detail matters. It means your income follows your skill and your activity, and it means nobody will hold your hand. This book is designed for that reality. Every lesson gives you a way to think, a script you can adapt, a role play you can rehearse with a friend, and a drill you can do alone with your phone recorder.

Each lesson has the same shape so that you always know where you are. You begin with a short story, then you read the teaching, which always has at least four full paragraphs. After that you study a case study, rehearse a role play, complete a drill, check the common mistakes, and test yourself. Do not skip the role plays. Reading a script is like reading about swimming. You only learn when you speak the words out loud, hear your own voice, and feel where your tongue trips. Find a practice partner, a fellow student, a sibling or a friend who will play the prospect. If you have nobody, use your phone to record both sides and play it back.

Read This Before You Begin: Sources, Honesty and Income

How this book uses Brian Choi's work

The brief for this handbook asked for the Real Sales System and the Decision Tree Framework created by Brian Choi. Here is exactly what that means, because you deserve honesty. Brian Choi is a high ticket sales trainer who reports earning over \$228,000 in commissions in his first full year in sales and ranking as the number two closer at the training company 7th Level. His Real Sales System is a paid course that he sells through his own channels, and its scripts, templates and procedures are private. This book does not copy them, and it could not, because they are not public. What is public is his teaching philosophy. Profiles and his own pages describe an emphasis on activity and process over natural talent, on doing revenue producing work in the gaps between calls, such as following up with people who did not buy, rebooking no shows, asking for referrals, upselling existing customers and calling out to new leads, and on having a written process so that no opportunity is wasted. Those ideas run through this handbook and are credited where they appear.

The Decision Tree that you will meet in Lesson 2 is an original DSS teaching tool. It follows the same spirit, which is that a sales call is a series of choices and that a good closer always knows which branch they are on and what the next branch should be. It is not a copy of anything Brian Choi teaches, and we do not claim it is. If you want his exact scripts and templates, the honest path is to enrol in his programme yourself and use his materials alongside this book. Where a lesson names another author, such as Neil Rackham, Matthew Dixon, Chris Voss or Jeremy Miner, we explain the idea in our own words and point you to the original book so you can go deeper. The full source list is at the back.

How this book talks about money

Digital Sales School does not promise you a job. We prepare you to compete for one. Some closers earn very good money, but the figures you see in adverts are usually the top few people, and they tend to leave out the months of slow work before the first commission. Treat every income number in this book as an illustration for learning, not a forecast. Companies set their own commission plans, and you must always ask for yours in writing before you take a role. If anyone asks you to pay money to be hired as a closer, walk away. Real employers pay you. Real training schools, which is a different thing, tell you plainly what they charge and what they teach.

How the Book Is Organised

Part	What you learn	Lessons
1. Foundations	What a remote closer is, the Real Sales System mindset, and your Nigerian home office	1 to 3
2. The Tech Buyer	How software and AI products work, how buyers decide, and how to stay honest and legal	4 to 6
3. Activity and Pipeline	Your daily activity system, outreach, and getting people onto the call	7 to 9
4. The Decision Tree Call	Opening, discovery, gap building and qualification	10 to 14
5. Presenting	The pitch, the demo and the price	15 to 17
6. Objections and Closing	The objection map, money, delay and the close itself	18 to 21
7. After the Call	Follow up, dead lead revival, referrals and upsells	22 to 23
8. Going Professional	Metrics, call review, applying for roles, contracts, pay and the 30 day launch plan	24 to 26

A suggested pace. One lesson a day for 26 days works well for full time students. If you are working or studying, take one lesson every two or three days and never let more than a week pass without a role play. Momentum is fragile. A closer who practises for twenty minutes daily will beat one who crams for four hours once a week.

PART 1

Foundations

What the job really is, how a professional thinks about process, and how to build a home office that survives Nigerian conditions.

What a Remote Closer Really Is

By the end of this lesson you can:

- Explain the closer role in plain language and separate it from a setter, an account executive and a support agent.
- Describe how commission work behaves month to month, including the slow start.
- Recognise a genuine remote sales opportunity and spot the common scams.
- Explain your role in a 60 second interview answer.

Ngozi is a 24 year old graduate in Enugu with a second class upper in Microbiology and no job. Her cousin in Lagos tells her about remote sales. She watches three videos of young men in expensive rooms saying they made a fortune in ninety days. She feels excited and suspicious in equal measure. Her question is simple and fair: what does this person actually do all day, and could someone like me do it?

The job in plain language

A closer is the person who talks to an interested buyer and helps that buyer make a decision. Notice the order of the words. Somebody else, usually an advert, a webinar, a referral or a colleague called a setter, has already created the interest. The prospect has filled a form or booked a time on a calendar. Your work starts when the call starts. You greet them, ask questions to understand their situation, find out whether the product really solves something that matters to them, explain how it would work in their business or life, answer their worries, agree a price and payment method, and then help them take the next step, which is normally to pay or to sign. In technology sales the product might be a subscription to an accounting tool, an AI assistant for customer service, or a package of software setup and training. The word remote simply means you do all of this through Zoom, Google Meet, WhatsApp calls or phone calls, from your own room, usually for a company that could be in Lagos, London or Texas.

It helps to separate the roles that people often confuse. A setter, sometimes called an appointment setter or a sales development representative, finds or warms up leads and books the calls. A closer takes those calls and turns interest into a decision. An account executive is a closer with a longer sales cycle, often selling to companies through several meetings with several decision makers. A customer success manager looks after people after they have bought. Support agents fix problems. In small companies one person may wear two of these hats, and in this book we will train you to do the whole path from first message to signed deal, because a closer who understands the setter's work and the customer success work closes better than one who only knows the call.

How commission work really behaves

Most remote closers are paid on commission, which means a percentage of every sale they close, sometimes with a small base pay or a call allowance. The percentage, the rules for refunds, the payment dates and what counts as a closed sale are set by each company, and they differ a great deal. That is why you must ask for the compensation plan in writing and read it carefully. The important thing to understand is the shape of the income. In the first weeks you are learning the product, taking practice calls and probably closing few or no deals, so your income can be zero even while you work hard. Then a few deals land and the money arrives in lumps rather than in a smooth monthly salary. This is not a reason to avoid the work. It is a reason to plan your finances, to keep another income going while you ramp up, and to judge yourself on activity and skill in the early months rather than on the bank alert.

You will see very large numbers quoted online. Brian Choi, for example, reports that he earned over \$228,000 in commissions in his first full year and was the second highest closer on a team of fifteen to twenty. That is a real claim from a real trainer, and it is also an exceptional result achieved on a team with strong leads and a proven offer. It is useful as proof that the ceiling is high. It is a poor guide to what a typical beginner should expect. The honest approach is to treat such figures as evidence that a very disciplined person with a good process can do well, and then to focus on the controllable inputs, which are how many conversations you have, how well you run them, and how quickly you improve.

Why this work suits Nigerians who prepare properly

Nigeria has a large young population that is comfortable with phones, WhatsApp and persuasion. Many of us grew up watching parents haggle in Balogun Market or seeing a neighbour sell frozen fish on the street. We understand trust, relationships and price conversations at a deep level. What the market lacks is structure. Companies abroad and at home are hungry for people who can speak clearly, listen well and follow a process, and they can hire across borders. The price of entry is not a certificate. It is proof that you can do the job, which is why this course ends with a portfolio of recorded practice calls and a written system you can show an employer. The challenges are practical: calls often fall in the evening or night because of time zones, electricity and data can fail, and receiving foreign pay needs a proper account. Lesson 3 deals with these one by one.

Scams and false doors

Sadly, wherever there is a dream there is someone selling a shortcut. Be careful about any offer that asks you to pay a fee to be hired, that promises a fixed salary for a commission only job, that refuses to tell you the company name, or that wants you to receive and forward money for them. A real employer or agency will interview you, tell you the product, explain the pay plan, and often ask for a trial call. A genuine training school will tell you clearly that training is a paid service and that a job is not guaranteed. When in doubt, ask for the company website, search the founders on LinkedIn, and speak to someone who already works there. It costs you ten minutes and can save you a great deal.

CASE STUDY: NGOZI'S FIRST WEEK OF RESEARCH

Ngozi writes down three questions before she contacts any company: What exactly do you sell? How are closers paid, and can I have the plan in writing? Who trains new closers and how long before I take live calls? One company answers in detail and offers a paid two week trial. Another replies with a screenshot of a bank alert and asks her to pay ₦45,000 for a starter kit. Ngozi walks away from the second and joins the first. The lesson is that good companies are happy to answer specific questions, and vague ones use excitement to hide the gaps.

ROLE PLAY 1: THE SCREENING CALL

Recruiter: Thanks for joining, Ngozi. In your own words, what does a closer do?

Ngozi: A closer takes calls from people who already showed interest and helps them decide. I ask questions to understand their situation, check whether the product fits, explain how it would help, handle their worries honestly and, if it is a fit, help them take the next step.

Recruiter: What if they say no?

Ngozi: Then I want to know why. Sometimes it is timing, sometimes it is price, sometimes the product truly is not right for them. I stay respectful, I note the reason, and I follow up if the situation could change.

Recruiter: You have no sales experience. Why should we trust you with leads?

Ngozi: Fair question. I have practised the full call flow, and I can send you three recorded practice calls with my self review notes. I am also willing to start on a paid trial so you can judge me on real calls.

Practise it three times. Time yourself. Your answer to the first question should take about 40 seconds.

Drill. Write a 60 second answer to "What does a remote closer do and why are you suited to it?" Record it on your phone, listen back, and cut every filler word such as "you know" and "like". Then write your own three questions for any company that approaches you and keep them in your notes app.

Common mistakes. Believing income screenshots without asking about the typical result. Taking a role without seeing the commission plan in writing. Paying to be hired. Quitting a stable income before you have closed your first deal.

Self check. Can you name the difference between a setter and a closer? Can you say what you will ask before accepting any role? If yes to both, move on.

The Real Sales System Mindset and the DSS Decision Tree

By the end of this lesson you can:

- Explain why process and activity beat talent in the first year.
- List the revenue producing activities a closer does between calls.
- Read the DSS Decision Tree and name each node in a call.
- Explain why a written process protects you from bad days.

Kelechi is a natural talker. In his first month as a closer he closes two deals early and then hits a dry spell. He blames luck, the leads and the weather. His teammate Amaka, who is quieter, closes fewer deals in week one but keeps a log, follows up with every lead who did not buy, and rebooks every no show. By month three Amaka is ahead, and Kelechi cannot explain why. The answer is not talent. It is a system.

Process and activity over talent

New closers often believe that success belongs to people who are naturally charming. The evidence from working closers points the other way. Brian Choi's public story is a good example. In profiles of his career he says he does not credit a natural gift for selling. He says he focused on activity and process while his skills were still developing, because it takes most people years to become truly proficient. That is a comforting idea for a beginner, because activity and process are things you can decide today. Skill will grow with repetition, but in the meantime a person who makes more good conversations, follows up more consistently and keeps better records will outperform a more talented person who works in bursts. The lesson is to stop asking whether you are good enough and start asking whether your system is good enough.

What does activity mean in practice? Choi describes several things a closer can do instead of idly waiting when a call is a no show. You can follow up with leads who did not buy on earlier calls. You can rebook no shows by sending a friendly message. You can contact existing customers about upgrades or renewals, since selling more to people who already trust you is often easier than winning a stranger. You can ask happy customers for referrals. You can make outbound calls to new leads. All of these produce revenue, and none of them need inspiration. They need a list, a script and a timer. A closer who fills every spare hour with one of these activities is building a pipeline while others scroll their phones and wait for the next booking.

The second half of the mindset is process. A process is a written sequence of steps that you follow in the same way each time, with room for judgement inside the steps. It is the opposite of winging it. When you have a process, you can find out exactly where deals are lost. If people go quiet after the price, you know to work on the price step. If they never reach the call, you know the fault is in the booking step. Without a process every loss feels like fate, and every win feels like luck, so you learn nothing from either. A written process also protects you on the days you feel tired, discouraged or distracted, because it tells you what to do next when your emotions offer no guidance.

The third piece is honesty about time. Sales is a numbers game only in the sense that improvement comes from volume plus review. More calls with no review teaches you to repeat your mistakes faster. Review with no volume teaches you theory without proof. The professional pairs the two: a target for daily conversations, a call recorded and reviewed at least once a week, and a small list of specific behaviours to improve. In the rest of this book you will build that routine step by step, and by Lesson 24 you will have a full scorecard for it.

The DSS Decision Tree

Every sales call is a series of forks. At each fork you have a question in your mind, the prospect gives an answer, and the answer tells you which way to go. The DSS Decision Tree is our map of those forks. It is an original teaching tool, built in the spirit of treating a call as a set of decisions, and you will use it in every lesson from Part 4 onward. Below is the full tree at a glance. Read it slowly and do not worry about memorising it yet. You will practise each node separately.

```
START: Booked call
|
v
[1 CONNECT] Do they feel safe and heard?
no -> slow down, reset tone, restate purpose
yes -> continue
|
v
[2 SITUATION] Do I understand their current setup and goal?
no -> ask more situation questions
yes -> continue
|
v
[3 PROBLEM] Is there a real problem or missed goal?
no -> honest exit or reposition to a future need
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yes -> continue
|
v
[4 COST] Does the problem cost them something that matters?
no -> low urgency: nurture, do not push
yes -> continue
|
v
[5 DESIRE] Do they want it fixed now and see a path?
no -> explore what blocks them, then re-check
yes -> continue
|
v
[6 FIT] Right person, can decide, can pay, product fits?
no -> refer, downsell or exit kindly
yes -> continue
|
v
[7 PRESENT] Link the solution to their words, show price
|
v
[8 RESPOND] Objection? -> identify type -> answer -> re-check
|
v
[9 COMMIT] Ask for the decision and next step
|
+> YES: onboard, confirm payment, thank
+> NOT YET: set exact follow up date
+> NO: learn why, leave the door open

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Notice that most nodes have an honest exit. The tree does not force everybody to buy. A closer who pushes a person with no real problem into a purchase will face refunds, angry messages and a bad name. A closer who reads the tree properly saves the effort for people who can truly benefit, and that is both kinder and more profitable in the long run.

CASE STUDY: AMAKA'S LOG

Amaka keeps a simple spreadsheet with columns for date, lead name, source, outcome, reason and next action. After thirty calls she notices that 11 of her 14 losses happened after the price. She reviews the recordings and finds she was stating the price fast and quietly, as if apologising. She practises stating it calmly, then pausing. Over the next thirty calls her price stage losses fall to 6. She fixed a specific step because she had a process that showed her where the leak was.

ROLE PLAY 2: READING THE TREE WITH A COACH

Coach: Your last call, where did it stop moving?

Student: After I asked about their problem. They said everything was fine.

Coach: Which node is that?

Student: Node 3, problem. The answer was no, so I should have either exited kindly or asked about future goals.

Coach: What did you do instead?

Student: I started pitching anyway. That was wrong.

Coach: Good. Next call, when you hit a no at Node 3, what will you say?

Student: "It sounds like things are running well right now. What would need to change for you to look at something like this again?"

Drill. Copy the tree onto one page in your own handwriting. Then pick a recent conversation where you tried to persuade someone, even a family discussion, and mark which node you were on when it stalled. Also list five revenue producing activities you will do in every spare hour, and set a timer for the first block tomorrow.

Common mistakes. Waiting for talent to arrive. Treating downtime as free time. Pitching before the problem is confirmed. Keeping no records. Claiming the tree is an official Brian Choi product. It is not.

Self check. Say the nine nodes out loud without looking. Name three activities for a no show hour.

Your Nigerian Remote Office: Power, Data, Tools and Getting Paid

By the end of this lesson you can:

- Build a reliable home setup for calls with backup power and backup internet.
- Choose call and note tools and set up a simple CRM.
- Explain call recording consent under the Nigeria Data Protection Act.
- Describe the main ways Nigerians receive foreign payment and the cautions that apply.

Tunde is in Port Harcourt, on a call with a Texas company's biggest lead of the week. Twelve minutes in, the light goes off. His laptop has a full battery, but the Wi-Fi router dies with the power. He switches his phone hotspot on, but the call has already dropped and he sits in the dark refreshing his screen. The lead never rejoins. It was not a skill problem. It was a setup problem, and it cost him a deal.

Power and internet: build two of everything

A closer who cannot be reliably reached is a closer who cannot be paid. In Nigeria the two failures that damage calls most often are electricity and data, so your first investment should be redundancy. For power, a laptop battery alone is not enough, because your router and modem also need electricity. A small inverter or UPS that keeps the router running for several hours is often the single most valuable purchase. A charged power bank for your phone and a second charging cable are cheap extras. For internet, aim to have two independent connections, for example a home fibre or 4G router as your main line and a second SIM from a different network on your phone as backup. Test your backup before you need it by taking a practice call on it. You will learn quickly how your voice sounds and how much data a one hour video call actually uses.

Room and sound matter as much as signal. Choose the quietest corner you can find and face a window or lamp so your face is lit from the front. Use a wired or good Bluetooth headset with a microphone, because your voice is your product and prospects forgive a plain background much more easily than muffled sound. Tell the people in your house your call hours and hang a note on the door. If generators or traffic run outside at certain times, schedule your most important calls outside those windows where you can. None of this is glamorous, but it tells every prospect within ten seconds that you are a professional who can be trusted with their money.

Tools you will use every day

You need four kinds of tools. First, a video call tool such as Zoom or Google Meet, with a stable version installed and a test call done. Second, a note taking method, because you must capture the prospect's exact words in Node 2 to Node 5 of the Decision Tree, and memory is a poor recorder. Third, a simple CRM, which stands for customer relationship management and is just a place where you record every lead, what happened and what you will do next. A spreadsheet is enough at the start, with columns for name, source, date, stage, next action and next action date. Fourth, a calendar with reminders so that no follow up slips. Many companies provide their own CRM. Learn the discipline with your spreadsheet now, and the company tool will feel easy later.

Recording calls is one of the best ways to improve, but you must handle it correctly. The Nigeria Data Protection Act 2023 sets rules for how organisations collect and use personal data, including clear consent and safe storage, and the Nigeria Data Protection Commission enforces it. A voice recording of an identifiable person is personal data. Follow your company's policy first, since they usually control recordings, and always tell the prospect at the start of the call that the call may be recorded for training and quality and ask if that is fine. If they say no, do not record. This is not a legal opinion, and rules and guidance keep developing, so when your company has a legal contact, ask them. The habit of asking permission also builds trust, which helps every call.

Getting paid from abroad

If you work for a foreign company you will need a way to receive dollars. Options that Nigerian freelancers commonly use include Payoneer, virtual dollar accounts such as Grey and Raenest, and, when an employer uses an employer of record platform such as Deel, withdrawal through that platform to a Nigerian bank account. Availability, fees and rules change often. Guides published in 2026 note that the Central Bank of Nigeria has introduced additional requirements for international money transfer operators, that Wise does not offer direct USD receiving to Nigeria, and that exchange rate treatment differs between channels. Several of these guides are written by the companies selling the services, so read them with that in mind and compare at least two independent sources. Also, new Nigerian tax rules took effect on 1 January 2026 and are widely reported to cover income received through platforms such as Payoneer, so keep records of your payments and speak to a qualified tax professional. Use formal channels only, and never agree to receive or forward money for a stranger.

CASE STUDY: TUNDE'S FIX

After the lost lead Tunde buys a small inverter for his router, gets a second SIM on a different network, and sets a rule that every call begins with his

hotspot already on as a warm standby. Two weeks later the power goes out again during a call. His router stays alive, the call barely flickers, and he continues. He also prepares a reconnect script so that if a drop ever does happen, he recovers gracefully.

ROLE PLAY 3: RESCUING A DROPPED CALL

Situation: the call drops. You rejoin after two minutes.

Closer: Mr Bello, I am so sorry about that. My network dropped, and I would rather apologise than pretend it did not happen. Can you hear me clearly now?

Prospect: Yes I can. It happens.

Closer: Thank you for your patience. Last thing you were telling me was about the delay in your invoices. Can you pick up from there so I do not lose the thread?

Prospect: Sure, so the delay is around two weeks each month...

Notice: one clear apology, no long excuse, and an immediate return to the prospect's story.

Drill. Do a full setup audit today. Test both internet lines with a 10 minute call to a friend. Time how long your power backup lasts. Make your CRM spreadsheet with the six columns above and enter five imaginary leads. Then write your one sentence recording consent line and practise saying it warmly.

Common mistakes. Depending on one line. Sitting in a noisy place. Recording without saying so. Using a personal WhatsApp for everything. Mixing business and personal money. Not keeping payment records.

Self check. Can you name your backup for power and for internet? Can you say your consent line naturally? Do you know which payment channel you will research first?

PART 2

The Tech Buyer

How software and AI products work, how people really decide to buy, and how to sell with honesty inside the law.

Tech Product Literacy: Selling Software and AI Without Being an Engineer

By the end of this lesson you can:

- Explain subscription software, AI tools, apps and integrations in simple words.
- Translate features into business outcomes.
- Learn any new product to a selling standard in 72 hours.
- Answer a technical question you cannot answer without losing trust.

Emeka joins a company that sells CloudFlow, an imaginary AI workflow tool for small businesses. On his first live call a clinic manager asks, "Does it connect to our old billing software, and is our patient data safe?" Emeka freezes. He does not know. He mumbles something about "the tech team" and the call goes cold. Later he learns that both questions were easy to prepare for.

What you are actually selling

Most technology products fall into a few families, and once you know the families you can learn any product faster. Software as a service, usually written as SaaS, means the customer pays a monthly or yearly subscription to use a tool that lives on the internet, instead of buying a program once. Examples include accounting tools, school management systems, online store platforms and customer relationship tools. AI products are often built on top of large language models, which are systems trained on huge amounts of text so that they can write, summarise, answer questions and follow instructions. In a business setting an AI product might answer customer messages on WhatsApp, draft emails, sort invoices or search a company's documents. Apps are programs on a phone or a computer, and integrations are the connections that let one tool share information with another, for example a store app that sends each sale to an accounting sheet automatically. An API, which stands for application programming interface, is simply the doorway that lets one program talk to another.

Prospects do not buy any of that. They buy an outcome, which is a better result in their business or life. A clinic does not want an AI scheduler, it wants fewer missed appointments and less time on the phone. A school owner does not want a fee management platform, she wants to stop chasing parents and to see on Monday morning who has paid. A trader in Ariaria does not want inventory software, he wants to know that the stock in his shop matches the book and that his boy is not quietly selling on the side. Your job is to hold every feature in one hand and the customer's outcome in the other and to connect them in words the customer uses. A good habit is to write each feature as a sentence that starts with "so that". This feature lets you do this, so that this problem goes away.

Learn a product in 72 hours

You do not need to become an engineer, but you must become a confident user. In the first day, use the product yourself for real. Create an account, set up a fake business, and complete the main task the customer would do. Take notes on every point where you felt confused, because your future prospects will feel the same confusion. On the second day, study the customer. Read the company's best customer stories, listen to recorded calls from strong closers, and list the ten most common questions and the answers the team uses. On the third day, practise the pitch and the demo out loud, and write a one page cheat sheet with the main outcomes, the price, the limits and the honest answers to security and integration questions. A person who has done these three days is more knowledgeable about the product than most of the prospects will ever be, and that is the standard you need.

Limits deserve special attention. Every product has things it does not do well, and every good closer knows them and says so calmly. This is not weakness. It is the fastest way to earn trust, because buyers in a market with many failed vendors listen for honesty. If a prospect asks whether an AI assistant will always give correct answers, the truthful answer is no, because these systems can produce confident mistakes, so you explain how the product is set up to reduce that risk, for example by limiting it to the company's own documents and letting a human review important replies. When a security question comes up, you do not guess. You say what you know, you say what you will confirm, and you follow through in writing. A prospect who sees you handle a hard question with care will trust your answers on the easy ones.

The last skill is the technical bridge. When you are asked something you cannot answer, use a three part move that you can rehearse until it is automatic. First, welcome the question so the prospect feels respected. Second, be honest that the detailed answer belongs to a specialist. Third, commit to a specific time for the answer and, if possible, offer to bring the specialist to a short follow up call. This is different from waffling. Waffling tries to hide ignorance. The bridge turns ignorance into a demonstration that you are reliable. Many deals in software are won by the closer who replies with a clear written answer within hours while competitors take days.

Word	Plain meaning
Onboarding	The first steps a new customer takes to start using the product
Churn	Customers who stop paying and leave
Integration	A link that lets two tools share information
Uptime	The share of time a product is working
Trial	A short period to test the product before paying
Hallucination	When an AI produces a confident but wrong answer

CASE STUDY: EMEKA'S 72 HOURS

After the failed clinic call Emeka blocks three days. He sets up a fake clinic in CloudFlow, connects it to a spreadsheet as a stand in for billing software, and writes down that the tool can import records but cannot write to two old billing systems that have no API. He asks the engineering team about data protection and receives a two paragraph written answer that he saves. He builds his cheat sheet. On his next clinic call the same question arrives and he answers in 40 seconds, with the limit and the workaround, and the manager says, "Finally someone honest." That call closes.

ROLE PLAY 4: THE QUESTION YOU CANNOT ANSWER

Prospect: Does your tool meet Nigerian data protection requirements?

Closer: Good question, and one I take seriously. What I can tell you is how the product stores and protects data, and I will send you our written data protection summary today. On the exact legal position under the Nigeria Data Protection Act, I want our compliance lead to answer rather than me guessing. Can I book fifteen minutes with them tomorrow, and would your data officer like to join?

Prospect: Yes, I would like that.

Closer: Perfect. I will send the invitation and the summary within the hour.

Drill. Pick any real software product you can try free. Spend one hour using it, then write ten "so that" sentences, five limits, and answers to the questions "Is my data safe?" and "What if I want to leave?". Present it aloud to a friend in five minutes.

Common mistakes. Reciting features. Pretending to know. Overpromising what AI can do. Leaving technical questions unanswered for days.

Self check. Can you explain SaaS, AI tool and integration to a shopkeeper in three sentences each?

How Nigerians Decide: Trust, Psychology and the Buying Mind

By the end of this lesson you can:

- Explain fast and slow thinking and why emotion starts most decisions.
- Use social proof, authority, reciprocity and commitment honestly.
- Recognise the trust barriers in the Nigerian market and answer them.
- Adjust your tone for respect, status and relationship.

Mrs Adeyemi owns a private school in Ibadan. Two years ago a vendor collected ₦400,000 for a school portal and disappeared. When Ngozi, now a closer, books a call with her, Mrs Adeyemi opens with, "Before you say anything, I have been cheated before." A weak closer would rush to the product. A skilled closer hears that sentence as the whole conversation.

Emotion first, logic second

Psychologists use the terms fast thinking and slow thinking to describe two ways people decide. Daniel Kahneman, in his book *Thinking, Fast and Slow*, describes a quick, automatic, emotional system and a slower, effortful, reasoning system. Buyers like to believe that they use the second one, and they do use it, but mostly to justify a feeling they already had. A school owner feels relief when she imagines never chasing fees again, and then she uses logic to check the price and the risk. This matters for your calls because the early part of a conversation must be about how the prospect feels, what frustrates them and what they hope for. When you lead with data and features, you speak to the slow system before the fast system has agreed to listen, and the prospect politely checks out.

Robert Cialdini's book *Influence* describes several well studied patterns in how people are persuaded, including reciprocity, commitment and consistency, social proof, authority, liking, scarcity and unity. You can use them ethically or unethically, and the difference is whether they are true. Social proof is ethical when you share a real customer story from a school of similar size, and unethical when you invent one. Scarcity is ethical when a cohort truly has limited seats or a promotion truly ends on a date, and unethical when you claim a fake deadline to rush a decision. Reciprocity works when you give real value first, for example a free audit of how the school currently collects fees. Commitment works when you help the prospect state their own goals aloud, because people tend to act in line with what they have said. If you practise these honestly, you gain long term trust. If you fake them, the market is small and word travels fast, especially on WhatsApp groups.

In Nigeria there is an extra layer, which is the trust deficit created by scams and by projects that started strongly and died. Many prospects have paid a developer who vanished, lost money to a fake investment scheme or waited months for a vendor who kept saying next week. When you meet this wall, do not treat it as an insult. Treat it as information about what the prospect needs. They need evidence, which means named customers, a demo they can touch, written terms, a payment method with a receipt, and a way to speak to someone who already uses the product. They also need time to consult. In our culture a big decision is often discussed with a spouse, a pastor, a business partner, an accountant or a cousin, and the prospect who says "let me consult" is usually being honest rather than making an excuse. Lesson 20 shows how to include those people rather than fight them.

Finally, respect is a sales skill. In Nigerian business conversation, titles and tone carry weight. Address older prospects as Sir, Ma, Mr or Mrs unless invited otherwise, greet properly before you jump in, and avoid slang with people who did not use it first. Speak at a calm pace, because rushing sounds anxious and disrespectful. At the same time do not be a pushover. Warm respect combined with clear questions and steady confidence is the tone that works on both a hospital administrator in Abuja and a fintech founder in Lekki. If you are unsure, mirror the prospect's formality slightly below their level and let them relax you upward.

CASE STUDY: MRS ADEYEMI

Ngozi does not go to the product. She says, "Thank you for telling me. Can you share what happened? I would like to understand what a good vendor should have done differently." Mrs Adeyemi talks for four minutes. She wanted a written scope, a demo before payment, a small first payment and a named contact. Ngozi writes these down and later offers exactly that: a live demo with her own school's data, a two stage payment, and the phone number of a headmistress in Osogbo who uses the tool. The school signs on the second call. Ngozi did not defeat the objection. She let the prospect design the safe way to buy.

ROLE PLAY 5: THE CHEATED PROSPECT

Prospect: Before you say anything, I have been cheated before. I do not want to waste my time.

Closer: I am sorry that happened, Ma. That kind of experience makes anyone careful. Would you mind telling me what went wrong, so I can be sure I never do the same to you?

Prospect: They took the money, sent one small demo and stopped picking my calls.

Closer: That is terrible. If we go forward, what would make you feel safe at the start, even before we talk about the product?

Prospect: A demo with my own data, and I do not want to pay everything upfront.

Closer: Those are fair requests. Let us start with the demo and I will show you how the payment can be split.

Drill. List five reasons a Nigerian prospect might distrust a vendor and write one honest proof you could offer for each. Then role play the cheated prospect scene with a partner until you can stay calm through the first hard line.

Common mistakes. Reciting persuasion tricks. Faking scarcity. Rushing past emotion. Ignoring status and greeting. Treating consultation as stalling before asking who will be consulted.

Self check. Name three principles of persuasion and one honest way to use each. Say how you would answer "I have been cheated before."

Ethics, Consent and the Law: Selling Honestly in Nigeria

By the end of this lesson you can:

- State the lines a professional closer never crosses.
- Explain consent and data handling basics under the Nigeria Data Protection Act.
- Handle claims about results and refunds truthfully.
- Turn away a bad fit without shame.

Bola is a closer selling an AI customer service bot. A prospect asks, "Will this double my sales?" Bola's manager's script says, "Yes, clients see 2x growth." Bola knows only two customers saw that result, and both had unusual conditions. He has ten seconds to choose between the script and the truth.

The lines you never cross

Sales has a reputation problem because a small number of people have used pressure, lies and confusion to move money. You will meet closers who defend this as normal. It is not normal for a professional, and it is not smart, because in a market like ours reputation compounds. Your first line is truthfulness about the product. You do not claim features that do not exist, results that were not typical, or partnerships that were never signed. Your second line is truthfulness about the customer's situation. You do not exaggerate their problem to frighten them or hide the cost of the solution. Your third line is respect for their freedom to say no. A person who feels pushed will pay you once and tell twelve others. A person who feels respected may say no today and refer you next month.

Results claims deserve extra care. When you talk about what other customers achieved, use the language of typical and specific. Say what you actually know: which customer, what size, what they did, what happened, how long it took. If your company publishes only best case numbers, ask for the range, and when a prospect asks about guarantees, do not invent one. It is completely acceptable to say, "I cannot guarantee a result, because it depends on how you use it, but here is what customers with a similar setup have seen and here is what I would need from you." Serious buyers trust this answer more than a promise. If the company forces you to make claims you cannot support, you have learned something about the company, and you should consider whether to stay. Consumer protection law in Nigeria, overseen by the Federal Competition and Consumer Protection Commission, exists precisely because misleading claims harm people, and your personal name goes on every call.

Data and consent are the technical side of honesty. The Nigeria Data Protection Act 2023 created the Nigeria Data Protection Commission and set out how organisations should collect and use personal data. Summaries of the Act highlight the need for clear consent or another lawful basis, security of data, rights for individuals to access and correct their data and object to certain uses, special rules for children's data, restrictions on cross border transfers and duties to report serious breaches. A closer touches personal data all day: names, phone numbers, business details, sometimes recordings. Practical habits protect you and the company. Collect only what you need. Do not paste customer details into public chat tools or personal WhatsApp groups. Keep notes in the approved CRM. Ask before recording. Do not add people to marketing lists without consent. If a prospect asks you to delete their information, pass it to your company's data officer quickly. This is an educational overview and not legal advice, so use your employer's policy as your main guide.

The last skill is turning away a bad fit. A closer is not paid to sell to everybody. Sometimes the product will not solve the prospect's problem, or the person cannot afford it without harming their business, or they want something illegal or misleading. In each case the ethical and the profitable answer usually agree: decline politely, say why, and recommend an alternative if you honestly know one. This protects you from refunds and chargebacks, protects the brand from angry reviews, and builds your reputation as a person who tells the truth. Over time, prospects begin to trust your recommendation precisely because you sometimes say no.

CASE STUDY: BOLA'S TEN SECONDS

Bola answers, "I cannot promise double. What I can say is that two customers saw close to that, and they both had heavy after hours enquiries. If most of your enquiries come after closing time, you could see a real lift. Can we look at your numbers?" The prospect, a restaurant owner, says she gets almost no after hours messages. Bola advises her that this tool may not be worth it yet and recommends starting with a simple menu link on WhatsApp. She thanks him and refers a friend whose business fits perfectly. That friend buys the same week.

ROLE PLAY 6: THE GUARANTEE QUESTION

Prospect: Can you guarantee this will pay for itself in three months?

Closer: I wish I could, but a guarantee from me would not be honest, because it depends on how you use it. What I can do is show you the numbers from three customers with a similar setup, the range they saw, and the two things they did that made the biggest difference.

Prospect: That sounds more real than most vendors.

Closer: Thank you. Shall we go through your own numbers so we can see whether your case looks like theirs?

Drill. Write your personal code of conduct in eight lines, including what you will say when your manager or script asks you to overstate results. Keep it in your notes and read it before each week of calls. Practise the guarantee answer until you can say it without hesitation.

Common mistakes. Repeating best case numbers as typical. Recording without notice. Saving client data in personal chats. Forcing a sale on a poor fit. Promising refunds you cannot authorise.

Self check. Can you give your three lines of honesty, and your consent line for recording, and a polite way to turn down a bad fit?

PART 3

Activity and Pipeline

The daily system that keeps deals flowing: your schedule, your outreach and the art of getting people onto the call.

Your Daily Activity System

By the end of this lesson you can:

- Build a daily schedule with call blocks, prospecting blocks, follow up blocks and review blocks.
- Use pipeline arithmetic to set daily activity targets.
- Fill no show and waiting time with revenue producing work.
- Keep a one page daily scorecard.

Chinedu works from Lagos for a company whose leads book calls mostly between 5pm and 11pm Lagos time. From 8am to 4pm he has nothing scheduled. For the first two weeks he sleeps late, scrolls, watches sales videos and feels busy without being productive. His manager asks a simple question: "What did you do today that could produce a sale?" Chinedu has no answer.

Why a system beats motivation

Motivation is a poor manager. It arrives in bursts, leaves without warning, and cannot be scheduled. A daily activity system is a set of blocks in your calendar with defined tasks, so that whether you feel inspired or tired the work is already decided. Jeb Blount, in his book Fanatical Prospecting, argues that consistent prospecting is the foundation of sales success because pipelines run dry when people stop filling them. Brian Choi makes a similar point in a different form: fill every gap between calls with activities that make money, and do not wait for the next booking to feel useful. If you adopt both ideas you will treat your day as a factory with clear stations, and your job is to keep every station running at the same time.

A workable day for a closer with evening calls has four kinds of block. The first is a prospecting or outreach block, where you contact new leads, in line with the rules in Lesson 8. The second is a follow up block, where you contact people who did not buy earlier, rebook no shows, and message people who received a proposal. The third is a call block, protected and free of interruptions, where you take live conversations. The fourth is a learning and review block, where you listen to one recorded call, update your notes and practise one weak skill. Keep the review block short but do it every day. A closer who reviews one call a day for six months has heard and repaired more than a hundred mistakes, and that is how skill is built behind the scenes.

Numbers keep the system honest. Suppose, for illustration only, that your company gives you 100 booked calls in a month. If 65 of them show up, you have 65 real conversations. If 40 of those are qualified, meaning they have a real problem and the ability to pay, and you close 12 of the 40, you earn 12 sales from 100 bookings. Now you can see that a small gain at any step lifts the result. Raising your show rate from 65 to 75 adds ten conversations. Raising your close rate on qualified calls from 30 percent to 35 percent adds two sales. Real numbers vary hugely by company and product, so your own log will replace this example, but the method is the same. Know your figures at each stage, find the weakest, and improve that one first.

Finally, protect your energy. A closer's voice and attention are the tools of the trade, and both decline when you are tired, hungry or anxious. Sleep at regular hours even when calls run late. Eat before the call block, drink water, stand and stretch between calls, and end each day by writing tomorrow's top three tasks. If your calls fall at night in Lagos because your prospects are in the United States, shift your whole day accordingly. Many remote closers in Nigeria keep late afternoon to midnight as their working shift and treat the morning as protected sleep and exercise. The point is not the specific hours. The point is that your week has a rhythm you can repeat.

Block (example, evening shift)	Time	Purpose
Review and prepare	1:00 pm to 2:00 pm	Listen to one call, update notes, read tomorrow's leads
Follow up block	2:00 pm to 4:00 pm	Rebook no shows, contact earlier prospects, send proposals
Outreach block	4:00 pm to 5:00 pm	New leads through approved channels
Call block	6:00 pm to 11:00 pm	Live calls, with notes typed as you go
Wrap up	11:00 pm to 11:30 pm	Update CRM, write scorecard, set tomorrow's top three

CASE STUDY: CHINEDU'S RESET

Chinedu builds the table above. In the morning he handles exercise, errands and rest. At 2pm he starts the follow up block. In the first week he rebooks 14 no shows, and six of them attend. Two of those close. He had never before contacted a no show. His manager notices the change in his log and gives him more leads. The tools were the same. The difference was a system that put him in front of opportunities.

ROLE PLAY 7: THE MANAGER CHECK IN

Manager: How many follow ups did you send this week?

Chinedu: Forty two. Fourteen of them were no shows, and six attended after my message.

Manager: What did you learn from the eight who did not respond?

Chinedu: Most were booked more than four days before the call. I want to test a shorter booking window and an extra reminder.

Drill. Create your own four block schedule for one week. Mark it in your calendar with alarms. At the end of each day fill a scorecard: outreach sent, follow ups sent, calls taken, deals closed, one lesson learned. Keep it for seven days and review the pattern.

Common mistakes. Having no schedule. Treating downtime as free time. Skipping review. Working late with no sleep plan. Tracking feelings instead of numbers.

Self check. List five revenue producing things you can do when a call is a no show, without looking.

Prospecting and Outreach on WhatsApp, LinkedIn, Email and Phone

By the end of this lesson you can:

- Choose a channel for each type of prospect.
- Write a short outreach message that earns a reply.
- Follow consent rules and respect the prospect's time.
- Ask for referrals with a script.

Chidi sells an inventory app for pharmacies. He sends 200 copy and paste messages to pharmacy owners, all starting with "Greetings sir, I am from ShopSync, the best inventory solution in Nigeria." He gets two replies and one of them says stop. He asks himself what he did wrong. The honest answer is that nothing in the message showed he understood the owner's world.

Prospecting is starting conversations

Prospecting means finding people who might have the problem your product solves and starting a conversation with them. Many closers in remote roles receive booked calls from marketing and do not prospect much, but you will still need outreach skill for follow up, for referrals, for outbound roles and for your own opportunities. A message that works has four traits. It is about them and not about you. It is short enough to read on a phone in ten seconds. It shows a small piece of real knowledge, such as a detail about their business or their industry. And it ends with an easy, low pressure question. Compare "I am from ShopSync and we are the best inventory system, can I book a demo?" with "Good afternoon Mr Yusuf. Many pharmacies in Ikeja tell us expiry dates and out of stock drugs eat their margin. Is that a headache for you too?" The second message invites a reply because it is a real question about a real problem.

Channel choice matters. WhatsApp is the most natural channel in Nigeria and very powerful for follow up, because people read messages quickly and it feels personal. It is also the easiest place to become annoying, so keep messages short, avoid sending voice notes to strangers on the first touch, and never add someone to a group without asking. LinkedIn works well for company decision makers, especially in technology, finance and consulting, and a short personalised connection note followed by a helpful message beats a pitch. Email suits longer thoughts, proposals and formal contacts, and phone calls are fastest for warm leads who requested contact. Whatever channel you use, consider the data protection rules. The Nigeria Data Protection Act requires a lawful basis for using personal data and gives people the right to object, so honour opt outs at once, keep your lists small and relevant, and follow your company's rules about who you may contact.

Structure your first message in three short moves. Start with a relevant opener that shows you know something about them. Follow with one sentence naming a problem people in their position often mention. Close with a question that is easy to answer. Then wait. If there is no reply, follow up in two or three days with something different, not a repeat. A useful pattern is to send a short tip, a relevant story of another business, or a helpful observation. After three attempts, pause for a month rather than chasing. Persistence is a virtue, but chasing someone who has ignored four messages tells them you are not listening.

Referrals are the warmest prospecting of all. A happy customer knows other people with the same problem and can introduce you with a sentence that carries more weight than any advert. The best time to ask is right after a win, for example after the customer sees their first result, when they are proud and grateful. Ask specifically. Do not say "Do you know anyone?" because that question is too vague to answer. Say, "Who is one other pharmacy owner you know who also struggles with expiry dates? Would you be comfortable sending them a short message from me, or would you prefer I write it and you forward it?" Making the task easy raises the chance that they do it. Thank them afterwards and tell them how it went.

CASE STUDY: CHIDI'S REWRITE

Chidi rewrites his message to mention expiry dates and to end with a question. He sends 60 messages to pharmacies in a single Lagos district. Sixteen reply, nine agree to a short call, and three become customers. He notes that replies come faster on Tuesday and Wednesday afternoons and that a voice note only works after they have replied. With those two adjustments his reply rate rises again. He also asks his first customer for a referral and receives two warm introductions.

ROLE PLAY 8: WHATSAPP OPENER AND REPLY

Closer: Good afternoon Mr Yusuf. I work with pharmacies in Ikeja on stock and expiry tracking. Many owners tell us that drugs expiring on the shelf quietly eat their profit. Is that something you deal with?

Prospect: Yes o. It is a big headache.

Closer: Thank you for sharing that. Out of curiosity, how do you track expiry dates today, a book or your staff's memory?

Prospect: Mostly a book. Sometimes we miss.

Closer: Understood. Would it help if I showed you a 10 minute look at how other pharmacies handle it, and you decide if it is useful? I can do tomorrow at 4 or Thursday at 11.

Drill. Choose an industry you know. Write three outreach messages for different owners, each with a relevant opener, one problem line and a question. Test one on a real friend who owns a business and ask how it feels to receive. Then write your referral script and say it aloud.

Common mistakes. Copy paste messages. Starting with "the best" claim. Long paragraphs. Ignoring opt outs. Adding people to groups. Asking "know anyone?" instead of naming a specific type.

Self check. Can you write a 3 sentence outreach message in under two minutes for any given industry?

Getting Them on the Call: Confirmations, Reminders and No Show Rebooking

By the end of this lesson you can:

- Explain why show rate is a critical number.
- Run a reminder sequence that raises attendance.
- Use pre call questions to raise commitment.
- Rebook no shows with a respectful script.

Fatima's calendar shows 20 bookings for the week and she feels wealthy. On Friday she sees that only eleven people attended. Nine hours of her life sat empty. She learns that the nine no shows all booked six days earlier and had no reminder except the automatic email. She has not lost interest. She has lost contact.

Show rate is money

You cannot close a person who does not arrive. Every no show is a cost: the effort and money that went into producing the lead, the time you protected, and the chance of the deal. A no show does not always mean the person is uninterested. Life happens, phones die, generators fail and traffic swallows evenings. Many prospects also book on impulse when an advert catches them at an emotional moment and forget by the time the call arrives. Show rate is the percentage of booked calls that actually happen, and you should track it weekly. A closer with a strong reminder system can lift show rate by a large margin without changing the product or the script, and that lift comes at no ad cost.

A good reminder sequence has several touches, each with a small purpose. Immediately after booking, send a warm confirmation that repeats the day, time and time zone, names the person they will speak with, and says what the call will cover. Twenty four hours before, send a friendly reminder and ask them to reply "yes" to confirm. Two hours before, send a short message with the link. Fifteen minutes before, send a final "See you shortly" message. Keep your tone human, and vary the wording from what an automatic tool would send. A voice note or a short call can work well for high value prospects. Time zone confusion is a common hidden cause of no shows, especially between Nigeria and other countries, so always state both time zones in writing, for example "4pm Lagos time, which is 10am in Chicago."

Commitment raises attendance. When a prospect has said in their own words why the call matters, they are more likely to show. Add two or three pre call questions to the booking form or confirmation message. Ask what they hope to get from the call, and what would make it a good use of their time. When they reply, you have their own reason on record, and you can refer to it at the start of the call. You can also make a gentle request such as, "If something comes up, would you please tell me so I can offer your slot to someone else?" This is not a threat. It treats their time and yours as valuable. Prospects usually respond by keeping the appointment or rescheduling in advance.

When a person does not show, act quickly and kindly. Wait ten minutes, send a short message, and offer two new times. Do not scold and do not sound hurt. Brian Choi lists rebooking no shows among the revenue producing activities he encourages closers to do instead of waiting idly. The reason is simple. A no show already showed interest, which makes them warmer than a cold lead. A friendly rebooking message often gets a reply within hours, and a large share of rebooked calls end up as real conversations. Try twice on the first day and once more two days later. After that, move them to your longer follow up list, which you will build in Lesson 22.

CASE STUDY: FATIMA'S SEQUENCE

Fatima adds the four touch reminder sequence with both time zones and two pre call questions. She also starts sending a personal voice note the morning of every call for prospects over a certain size. Over the next month her show rate rises from 55 percent to 74 percent. She takes the same number of bookings but has nearly twice as many conversations. Her income follows within six weeks.

ROLE PLAY 9: THE NO SHOW REBOOK

Closer (message): Good evening Mrs Okon. We were meant to speak at 6pm and I know evenings can get busy. No wahala at all. Would tomorrow at 5pm or Thursday at 12 noon work better for you?

Prospect: Sorry, network was bad. Tomorrow 5 is fine.

Closer: Perfect, tomorrow 5pm Lagos time. I will send you a reminder tomorrow morning. Please reply "yes" to confirm so I have it in my diary.

Drill. Write your full reminder sequence with the exact wording of each message, including both time zones. Then write two pre call questions for a product of

your choice. Practise the rebooking message on a friend and ask if it sounds friendly or nagging.

Common mistakes. Relying only on automatic email. Forgetting time zones. Long booking windows. Scolding no shows. Giving up after one message.

Self check. State your show rate formula and name three touches in a reminder sequence.

PART 4

The Decision Tree Call

The heart of the book: how to open a call, discover the real problem, build the gap and confirm that the person can buy.

Running the Tree: Notes, Branching and Staying in Control

By the end of this lesson you can:

- Take call notes that map to the nine Decision Tree nodes.
- Decide at every moment which node you are on and what comes next.
- Steer a wandering conversation back without sounding rude.
- Recover when you skip a node.

Segun finishes a 50 minute call feeling good. The prospect was friendly, they laughed and talked about football, and Segun pitched at the end. The prospect said, "Let me think about it," and never replied. When Segun reviews his notes he finds two lines. He does not know what the prospect's problem was, what it cost, or who else decides. He enjoyed a pleasant conversation and learned nothing he could use.

Why the tree is a working tool

In Lesson 2 you met the full Decision Tree. Now you will use it as a working tool during real calls. The core idea is that a call moves through stages and that each stage has a job. At Node 1 your job is to make the person feel safe and heard. At Node 2 you learn their situation. At Node 3 you find out whether a real problem or a missed goal exists. At Node 4 you learn what that problem costs them. At Node 5 you check whether they actually want it fixed now and can see a path. At Node 6 you confirm fit, authority and ability to pay. Only at Node 7 do you present. Most struggling closers present at Node 2. They meet a friendly person and start explaining the product before they have any idea what it needs to fix, and the pitch lands in a vacuum.

Notes are how you stay oriented. Use a simple layout with the node numbers down the left side of your page or screen and their exact words beside each. Under Node 3 write the problem in their language. Under Node 4 write the numbers and consequences, such as lost hours, lost money, stress or missed goals. Under Node 5 write what they said about wanting change and what they have already tried. Under Node 6 write the decision maker's name, the budget range and the timeline. The exact phrases matter, because later in the presentation you will echo them. When the prospect hears their own words repeated back, they feel understood, and understanding is at the root of trust. Notes also protect you from the trap of pitching from memory of the product instead of from knowledge of the person.

Control means you decide the direction of the conversation while the prospect feels respected. New closers often think control means talking more. It means the opposite. The person asking questions steers the call, and the person answering does the thinking. When a prospect wanders, for example into a long story about a cousin's failed business, listen for the point, acknowledge it briefly, and steer back with a question that links to the node you need. You might say, "That sounds frustrating. It makes me want to understand your own situation better. When you take a new order today, what happens first?" You have honoured the story and returned to Node 2 without a lecture. If the prospect asks for the price early, do not dodge or blurt. Give a range or promise to cover it fully in a few minutes once you understand what they need, so the number makes sense in context.

Sometimes you will skip a node by accident. You may hear the price objection before you have built any cost of the problem, or you may discover halfway through the pitch that the person is not the decision maker. Do not panic. The tree is a compass, not a cage. Say honestly, "I think I jumped ahead. Can I go back and ask two questions so I give you the right recommendation?" Most prospects respect this. It is far better than pressing on and creating an objection that could have been avoided. Over many calls, you will feel the nodes in your body, and you will notice when the conversation leaves the path before the prospect does.

CALL NOTE TEMPLATE

```
1 CONNECT   : name, role, mood, personal detail
2 SITUATION : how they do it today, tools, team, volume
3 PROBLEM   : "in their words" .....
4 COST      : hours / money / stress / missed goal
5 DESIRE     : what they tried, why now, what success looks like
6 FIT       : decision maker, budget range, timeline, blockers
7 PRESENT   : which 2 outcomes matter most (their words)
8 RESPOND   : objection type, my answer, re-check
9 COMMIT    : decision, next step, exact date
```

CASE STUDY: SEGUN'S BEFORE AND AFTER

Segun adopts the note template. On his next call with an events company owner he fills Node 3 with "we lose bookings when I am on the road because I cannot reply to WhatsApp fast enough" and Node 4 with "about six enquiries a week, roughly ₦150,000 each". Under Node 6 he writes that her husband also signs off on tools above a certain amount. When he presents, he uses her exact words, and he invites her husband to the second call. The deal closes in four days. The product was the same as on the earlier call. The information was different.

ROLE PLAY 10: STEERING BACK

Prospect: ...and that is why I never trust these online people. My cousin did the same and lost everything, you know, then his wife also...

Closer: I am sorry to hear that, Ma. It is a good reason to be careful. I would like to make sure this is right for you specifically, so may I ask, when a new booking comes in today, what happens first?

Prospect: Well, I write it in a book and then call the caterer.

Closer: I see. And after the caterer, what is the next step?

Drill. Watch or listen to any sales call, real or recorded, and fill the note template as you go. Mark which node the closer was on at each minute. Count how many minutes he spent on Nodes 2 to 5 compared with Node 7. Aim for at least half the call before the pitch.

Common mistakes. Chatting without direction. Pitching at Node 2. Skipping notes. Letting the prospect run the call. Refusing to go back a node when needed.

Self check. Can you name what you want to learn at each of the six discovery nodes?

Opening the Call: Connect, Set the Frame and Earn Permission

By the end of this lesson you can:

- Open a call with warmth and clarity in the first 90 seconds.
- Set an agenda and an up front agreement.
- Ask permission to record and to ask questions.
- Lower a prospect's guard without gimmicks.

Adaeze joins a call with a business owner who sounds tense. Her first sentence is, "Hi, I am Adaeze from BrightDesk, can I tell you about our product?" The owner sighs and says, "I only have ten minutes." Ten minutes later the call ends politely. Adaeze did not do anything rude. She simply started like every other salesperson the owner had spoken to that week.

The first 90 seconds decide the tone

People decide quickly how they feel about you. In the first minute they notice your voice, your pace, your greeting and whether you sound like someone who wants something or someone who can help. The best openings are calm, warm and clear. Greet by name, thank them for making time, and say who you are and what the call is for in one simple sentence. Then set the frame. The frame is the shared understanding of how the next thirty or forty minutes will work. You tell them the plan, you ask if it suits them, and you give them permission to say no at any time. When the prospect hears that they are in control, their defences drop, because the main fear in a sales call is being trapped.

A well known method for setting the frame is the up front agreement, taught by the training company Sandler and used in many forms. You agree three things at the start: the time, the plan and the outcome. For example, "We have about thirty minutes. I would like to ask you some questions about how you handle orders now, and then, if it looks like we can help, show you how it works. At the end you can tell me yes, no or not now, and any of those is fine. Does that work for you?" Notice the honesty in the last sentence. By making no an acceptable answer you make it easier for the person to say a real yes later. Prospects who feel safe to say no are less likely to hide behind vague phrases like "I will think about it."

Connection is not chit chat for its own sake. It is a short sign that you see the person as a human being. Use a real detail, such as their city, business name or something they said when booking. Ask one open question that lets them talk about themselves, such as "How did you start this business?" and listen. Do not use rapport as a tool for manipulation. It works because it is sincere. If you do not feel curious, practise curiosity as a skill by asking yourself what you would want to know if this were your friend's company. Keep this stage under three minutes for cold or busy people and a little longer for warm relationship driven prospects. Watch the prospect's energy. If they are clipped and quick, shorten the small talk. If they are chatty, give them room.

The final part of the opening is permission. Ask if it is fine to record the call, as you learned in Lesson 3. Ask if it is fine to take notes. Then ask for permission to ask direct questions: "To give you a useful recommendation I will ask some specific questions about how things work now. Some may be personal about money or staff. Is that okay?" This tiny step has a large effect. It signals respect, it prepares the prospect for depth, and it makes later questions about cost or decision making feel invited. Jeremy Miner of 7th Level, in his NEPQ approach, places great weight on this style of calm, non pushy opening, where the closer avoids sounding like a typical salesperson and leads with curiosity. You may find his work a useful extra reading, and the principle stands on its own: sound like a helper, not a hunter.

CASE STUDY: ADAEZE'S NEW OPENING

Adaeze rewrites her opening using the up front agreement. On her next call the owner again says he has ten minutes. Adaeze replies, "That is fine. Let me use them well. I will ask a few questions, and if it looks like a fit I will take about ten more minutes on another day, otherwise I will tell you honestly it is not for you. Is that okay?" He relaxes, the call runs 34 minutes, and he books a follow up demo with his partner.

ROLE PLAY 11: FULL OPENING SCRIPT

Closer: Good evening Mr Danjuma, this is Adaeze. Thank you for making time. How is your day going?

Prospect: Busy, but fine.

Closer: I appreciate that. You mentioned in your form that you run a logistics company in Kano. How did you get into that?

Prospect: Family business, we started with two trucks.

Closer: Impressive. Let me tell you how I would like to use our time. We have about thirty minutes. I will ask some questions about how you track deliveries now. If there is a fit I will show you how our tool works. At the end you can say yes, no or not now, and each is fine. Does that work?

Prospect: That is fair.

Closer: One more thing. I would like to record this for training and quality. Is that okay with you? And some of my questions will touch on money and staff. Is

it alright if I ask them directly?

Drill. Write your opening in full for your own product or a practice product. Record yourself saying it in under 90 seconds. Listen for a rushed pace, filler words and any part where you sound like you are reading. Repeat until it sounds like you talking.

Common mistakes. Starting with the company pitch. Long small talk with a busy person. Skipping recording consent. Forgetting to say that no is acceptable. Talking in a fast salesman voice.

Self check. Recite the three parts of an up front agreement and your consent line.

Discovery: Situation and Problem Questions

By the end of this lesson you can:

- Ask situation questions without boring the prospect.
- Ask problem questions that bring hidden pain to the surface.
- Use follow up prompts to go deeper.
- Handle a prospect who says they have no problem.

Ifeoma sells accounting software to small companies. On a call she asks, "What software do you use now?" and "How many staff do you have?" and "What is your turnover?" The prospect gives short, flat answers and grows more irritated. At the end he says, "Send me a brochure." Ifeoma asked many questions but none that helped him feel understood.

Two kinds of questions

Neil Rackham's research, published in his book *SPIN Selling* in 1988 after studying thousands of sales calls, gave the profession a useful vocabulary for questions. He found that questions about the buyer's situation, the problems they face, the implications of those problems and the payoff of solving them were powerful, and that the order and quality of those questions strongly affected success, especially in bigger sales. The word SPIN comes from the four types: Situation, Problem, Implication and Need payoff. In this lesson we cover the first two, which map onto Nodes 2 and 3 of the DSS Decision Tree. The next lesson covers the other two. You do not need to memorise the labels. You need to feel the difference between a question that gathers background and a question that uncovers something that matters.

Situation questions collect facts about how things work today. They are necessary but must be kept short, because prospects tire of being interviewed about basics. Do your homework before the call so you do not waste their time asking what is on their website. Ask only what you truly need. Good situation questions sound like, "Walk me through what happens when a new order comes in," "Who is involved from enquiry to delivery?" and "What tools do you use for that today?" Use open questions that begin with what, how or who so that the person gives a story, not a yes or no. After each answer, pause and let the silence do some work. Many prospects add the most useful sentence in the second or third second after you would normally jump in.

Problem questions are where the value appears. They invite the prospect to name difficulties, frustrations and gaps between where they are and where they want to be. Jeremy Miner's NEPQ approach in his book *The New Model of Selling* puts great emphasis on this kind of problem finding question over traditional pitching, and both his work and Rackham's agree on the principle that the prospect should describe their own problem in their own words. Try questions such as, "What is not working as well as you would like?" "What made you book this call now?" "If you could change one thing about how you handle this, what would it be?" and "What have you tried so far to fix it?" Then follow with gentle prompts like "Tell me more about that," "What do you mean by that?" and "How long has that been happening?" These follow ups are where you move from surface to depth.

What if the prospect says everything is fine? This is common and it has three possible meanings. They may truly have no problem, in which case the honest move is to say so and exit kindly, as the tree suggests at Node 3. They may not have noticed the problem, in which case you can ask about specific results, such as "How many enquiries did you miss last month?" They may not trust you enough to share, in which case more connection is needed. A helpful approach is to ask about goals instead of problems. "If things go well over the next twelve months, what would you like to be different?" People often reveal gaps when they talk about the future. If after a fair effort there is truly no problem and no goal that your product supports, thank them and leave. Time spent pitching a person with no problem is time stolen from someone who has one.

CASE STUDY: IFEOMA'S BETTER QUESTIONS

Ifeoma replaces her questionnaire with three moves. She asks the prospect to walk her through month end. Then she asks what part of it he dislikes most. Finally she asks what happens when it goes wrong. He tells her that the accountant works until midnight on the last two days of every month, that errors sometimes reach the tax filing, and that he has already paid one penalty. She has not yet said one word about her software, and he is already leaning in.

ROLE PLAY 12: DISCOVERY QUESTIONS

Closer: Walk me through what happens from the moment a customer enquires to the moment they receive your delivery.

Prospect: They call or WhatsApp, my sister writes it down, then my supervisor assigns a driver by phone.

Closer: And what part of that gives you the most trouble?

Prospect: When customers call asking where the truck is. We do not always know.

Closer: Tell me more about that.

Prospect: Sometimes the driver does not pick up. Last month a customer cancelled because we could not tell him where his goods were.

Closer: I see. What have you tried so far to solve it?

Drill. Write 8 situation questions and 8 problem questions for a product of your choice. Cut each situation question you can answer through research. Practise asking three problem questions in a row with two follow up prompts each, with a partner playing a reluctant prospect.

Common mistakes. Asking questions the website already answers. Yes or no questions. Interrupting silence. Never asking a follow up. Pitching when the answer is polite but shallow.

Self check. Write three problem questions from memory and three follow up prompts.

Building the Gap: Implication and Need-Payoff Questions

By the end of this lesson you can:

- Ask implication questions that let the prospect feel the true size of their problem.
- Ask need-payoff questions that let the prospect sell themselves on the benefit.
- Avoid the trap of manufacturing fear that is not real.
- Know when the gap is wide enough to move to Node 6.

Uche has heard the prospect describe a real problem: her online shop loses customers when nobody replies to Instagram messages overnight. Uche knows this is a strong opening, but on the last three calls he has jumped straight from hearing the problem to pitching the product, and each time the prospect said the price felt too high for "just a small issue." The problem was real. It simply never grew large enough in the prospect's own mind before Uche put a number next to it.

The problem alone rarely sells

Node 3 of the Decision Tree confirms that a real problem exists, and Node 4 asks what that problem costs. This is the step most beginners skip, and it is the step Neil Rackham's research identified as separating average sellers from strong ones on larger, more considered sales. Implication questions ask the prospect to connect a small stated problem to its wider consequences, in their own words, rather than you telling them what those consequences are. Consider the difference between saying, "Slow replies are costing you customers," which is you asserting a fact, and asking, "When a message goes unanswered overnight, what usually happens to that customer by morning?" The second question invites the prospect to discover and state the cost themselves, and a cost that a person says out loud in their own words lands far harder than the same cost stated by a stranger trying to sell them something.

Good implication questions chain together. You might ask about the immediate effect, then the effect on the effect, then the effect over time. "What happens to that customer by morning?" leads to "How often does that happen in a week?" which leads to "If that has been happening every week for the last year, what would you estimate that has cost you in total?" Notice how the number grows from something the prospect feels is small, one missed message, into something they realise is large, dozens of lost sales over months. You are not inventing the size of the problem. You are helping them calculate a size they had never added up before, because most people experience their problems one incident at a time rather than as a running total. This is also where Node 4 in your notes gets filled with real figures you can use later in the pitch.

Need-payoff questions do the opposite work. Instead of pointing at the cost of the problem, they point at the value of the solution, and critically, they let the prospect state that value rather than you stating it. Examples include, "If you never missed an overnight message again, what would that be worth to your monthly sales?" and "How would it feel to open your shop in the morning already knowing every message was answered?" and "What else would you be able to focus on if this stopped taking your time?" A prospect who says out loud, "That could easily be another two hundred thousand naira a month," has effectively built your business case for you, and they will defend that number far more strongly than they would defend a number you presented to them, because people are loyal to their own conclusions.

A serious caution belongs here. This tool can be misused to manufacture fear about a problem that is not really significant, and that misuse is exactly the manipulative selling this book has warned against since Lesson 6. The test is honesty: are you helping the prospect see a true cost they had not calculated, or are you inventing drama to frighten them into a decision that does not serve them? If a problem genuinely is small, your implication questions will reveal that too, because the prospect's own answers will stay modest, and that is useful information. It tells you the deal may be small, slow, or not worth pursuing right now, and Node 4 of the tree gives you permission to treat low urgency honestly rather than force urgency that is not there.

CASE STUDY: UCHE ADDS THE MISSING STEP

On his next call Uche hears the same overnight message problem. Instead of pitching, he asks, "How many messages would you guess go unanswered overnight in a typical week?" The owner guesses eight to ten. He asks, "Of those, how many do you think would have bought if answered quickly?" She says maybe half. He asks, "At your average order value, what would that be worth over a month?" She calculates it herself, aloud, and arrives at roughly ₦280,000. Uche writes that number down. When he later states the price of the tool, it sits comfortably beside a number the prospect built herself.

ROLE PLAY 13: CHAINING IMPLICATION AND NEED-PAYOFF

Closer: When a message goes unanswered overnight, what usually happens to that customer by morning?

Prospect: Honestly, they have probably already bought from another shop.

Closer: How often would you say that happens in a week?

Prospect: Maybe eight or ten messages come in overnight.

Closer: And if you had been able to reply instantly to all of those over the last year, what do you think that would have added to your sales?

Prospect: That is actually a lot when I think about it like that.

Closer: If that stopped happening completely, what would that be worth to you each month?

Drill. Take the problem your prospect stated in Lesson 12's drill and write a chain of three implication questions that grow the cost, followed by two need-payoff questions that let them state the value in their own words. Practise it aloud, pausing fully after each question until your partner has finished answering before you speak again.

Common mistakes. Skipping straight from problem to pitch. Stating the cost yourself instead of asking. Manufacturing fear about a genuinely small issue. Rushing through the chain instead of letting numbers build naturally.

Self check. Write one implication question and one need-payoff question for a problem you identified in an earlier lesson, without looking back at this page.

Qualification: Confirming Fit Before You Present

By the end of this lesson you can:

- Confirm decision-making authority without sounding accusatory.
- Ask about budget range respectfully and early enough to matter.
- Establish timeline and urgency honestly.
- Decide whether to present, refer, downsell or exit at Node 6.

Blessing spends fifty minutes on a beautiful call. The prospect, a warehouse manager, is engaged, asks smart questions, and seems ready to buy. At the end he says, "This looks great, let me show my director on Monday." Blessing never asked, at any point, whether he had the authority to approve the purchase. She built a perfect case for the wrong audience.

Fit has four parts, and all four matter

Node 6 of the Decision Tree asks a compound question: is this the right person, can they decide, can they pay, and does the product actually fit their situation? Skipping this node is one of the most common and most expensive mistakes a new closer makes, because it is entirely possible to run a warm, well-executed discovery conversation with someone who simply cannot say yes. This is not their fault, and it does not make the conversation wasted, because a well-qualified non-decision-maker can become your internal champion, the person who carries your case to the real decision maker. But you must know which situation you are in, and you must know it before you spend your best material on a full presentation.

Authority is best explored with curiosity rather than a blunt question like "Are you the decision maker?" which many people answer defensively even when it is not fully true, because admitting you cannot decide alone can feel like admitting a lack of status. Instead ask process questions: "Once you find something that looks right, what does the approval process usually look like?" or "Besides yourself, who else would want to weigh in before this moves forward?" These questions get the same information, a map of who else is involved, without putting anyone on the spot. If a spouse, business partner, co-founder or department head is part of the decision, as covered in Lesson 5's discussion of Nigerian family and business consultation, your job is not to fight that reality but to plan for it, ideally by inviting that person onto a later call.

Budget deserves a direct but gentle approach, raised at the right moment, which is after the prospect has already built some sense of the problem's cost in Lesson 13, not before. A useful frame is to normalise the question with a range rather than demanding an exact figure: "Different businesses at your stage typically invest somewhere between X and Y for something like this. Does that sound like it is in a realistic range for you, or would we need to look at something different?" This does two things. It tells the prospect roughly what to expect before the reveal, reducing shock later, and it gives you an early signal about whether you are heading toward a real conversation or toward a mismatch that is kinder to surface now.

Timeline and genuine fit complete the picture. Ask what is driving the timing of this search now, and what happens if nothing changes, which often reveals whether the need is urgent or exploratory. Also be honest with yourself about product fit: does what you sell actually solve what they described, at the size and complexity they operate at? If a prospect runs a two-person shop and your product is built and priced for fifty-person teams, forcing that sale creates a customer who churns, complains and damages your reputation, exactly the outcome Lesson 6 warned against. When any of the four elements of fit is clearly missing, and the tree's honest exit paths apply, refer them elsewhere, offer a smaller version if one genuinely exists, or close the conversation with warmth and leave the door open for the future.

CASE STUDY: BLESSING'S MISSED AUTHORITY CHECK

After the missed sale, Blessing adds one question to every call before she presents: "Once you and I agree this is right, what usually happens next on your side before it becomes official?" On her next call with a similar warehouse manager, the same situation appears, but now she learns it in real time. She asks whether the director could join a short quarter-hour call, offers to prepare a one-page summary of the manager's own numbers for that meeting, and the deal advances with the right person in the room from the start.

ROLE PLAY 14: UNCOVERING THE REAL DECISION PROCESS

Closer: This has been a great conversation. Once you and I agree something looks right, what does the approval process typically look like on your end?

Prospect: I would need to run it by my director.

Closer: That makes sense. Would it be useful if I put together a short summary of what we discussed today, the numbers included, so you have something solid to bring to that conversation, or would it be even better if your director joined us briefly on a follow-up call?

Prospect: A follow-up call would actually be better, he prefers to ask his own questions.

Closer: Perfect, let's find a time that works for both of you.

Drill. Write your own authority question, your own budget-range question, and your own timeline question, phrased so they sound curious rather than interrogating. Practise all three back to back with a partner playing a prospect who is not the final decision maker, and end the role play by proposing a concrete next step that includes the real decision maker.

Common mistakes. Asking "are you the decision maker" bluntly. Raising budget before any cost has been established. Ignoring a clearly poor product fit because the person is friendly. Presenting fully before checking any of the four fit elements.

Self check. Name the four elements of fit at Node 6 and one gentle question for each.

PART 5

Presenting

Turning everything you learned in discovery into a pitch, a demo and a price that feel inevitable rather than forced.

The Pitch: Presenting Their Words Back as a Solution

By the end of this lesson you can:

- Build a pitch from the prospect's own words rather than a memorised script.
- Use a simple three-part structure: their situation, the gap, the path.
- Present only the features that connect to what they told you.
- Check in during the pitch instead of monologuing.

Kunle has memorised his company's pitch deck word for word and can recite all eleven features of the product without pausing for breath. On a call with a restaurant owner who spent forty minutes describing exactly one problem, late supplier deliveries throwing off her weekend prep, Kunle delivers the full eleven-feature pitch anyway. She listens politely, thanks him, and never replies to his follow-up messages. He presented a product. He did not present a solution to her problem.

A pitch is not a recitation, it is a mirror

Everything you did in Lessons 10 through 14, the notes, the situation questions, the problem questions, the implication chain, the qualification, exists to make this moment possible: a presentation built almost entirely from the prospect's own words rather than your company's marketing copy. The strongest pitches in technology sales are not the ones that list the most features. They are the ones that feel, to the prospect, like the closer somehow already understood their business before the call started. That feeling is not magic. It is the direct result of taking careful notes at Nodes 2 through 6 and then, at Node 7, reflecting those exact words back inside a simple structure that shows the path from where they are to where they want to be.

A reliable three-part structure works across almost any technology product. Part one restates their situation and the specific problem in their language, briefly, so they hear that you listened: "You told me that when suppliers deliver late on weekends, your kitchen team scrambles and you have had to turn away two large weekend bookings this month because prep was not ready." Part two names the gap between that situation and what they said they wanted, using the numbers and value they gave you in the implication and need-payoff questions from Lesson 13: "You mentioned that fixing this could be worth as much as three hundred thousand naira a month in bookings you are currently turning away." Part three shows the path, which is your product, described only through the features that connect directly to what they told you, never the full feature list.

This last point deserves emphasis because it is where most new closers lose discipline. Your product may have twenty features. The prospect in front of you cares about perhaps three of them, the ones that touch the specific problem they described. Presenting the other seventeen does not build more value, it dilutes the three that matter and signals that you were not really listening, you were simply waiting for your turn to recite the deck. Before every pitch, look at your Node 3 through 5 notes and ask yourself: which features solve exactly this? Build your presentation from that short list only. If the prospect later asks about other capabilities, answer honestly and briefly, then return to the path you built.

A pitch should never run uninterrupted for more than a few minutes without checking that the prospect is still with you. Long monologues, even well-structured ones, lose people, especially on a video call where distractions are one tab away. Build in short check-ins: "Does that match what you were describing?" or "How does that land, does that address the weekend problem?" These pauses do two things. They keep the prospect engaged as a participant rather than an audience, and they surface confusion or disagreement early, while it is cheap to fix, rather than at the end when you ask for the decision and discover the pitch never actually landed. A pitch that invites reaction throughout is also a pitch that naturally sets up the objection-handling skills from Part 6, because objections raised mid-pitch are easier to handle than objections that have been silently building for ten minutes.

CASE STUDY: KUNLE REBUILDS HIS PITCH

Kunle goes back to his notes from a similar call and finds he had written down the weekend booking problem and a stated cost of roughly ₦250,000 a month. He builds a new three-part pitch using only the two features that manage supplier delivery windows and automatically alert the kitchen team. On his next call with a comparable restaurant owner, he opens the pitch with her own numbers, shows exactly those two features live, and checks in twice. She stops him once to ask a clarifying question, which he answers, and at the end she says, "That is exactly what I need," before he has even reached the price.

ROLE PLAY 15: THE THREE-PART PITCH

Closer: Based on what you told me, when a supplier delivers late on a Saturday, your kitchen team finds out too close to service, and you have had to turn away two large weekend bookings this month because prep was not ready in time.

Prospect: Exactly, it has been a real headache.

Closer: You mentioned that fixing this could be worth around two hundred and fifty thousand naira a month in bookings you are currently losing. What our

tool does specifically is flag a late delivery the moment it happens and automatically alert your kitchen lead by WhatsApp, so the team can adjust prep hours earlier instead of discovering it at service time. Does that match the gap you were describing?

Prospect: Yes, that is exactly the gap.

Drill. Using notes from any earlier lesson's role play, write a full three-part pitch limited to no more than three features. Mark two natural check-in points in the script. Deliver it aloud to a partner and ask them afterward which sentence made them feel most understood.

Common mistakes. Reciting the full feature list. Presenting from a memorised script instead of the prospect's notes. Talking for ten minutes with no check-in. Forgetting to restate their own numbers.

Self check. Name the three parts of the pitch structure and explain why feature selection matters.

The Demo: Showing, Not Just Telling

By the end of this lesson you can:

- Plan a demo around the prospect's own workflow, not a fixed tour.
- Handle a technical glitch during a live demo without losing the room.
- Let the prospect's hands touch the product when possible.
- Close each demo section with a small yes before moving on.

Ada runs the exact same twelve-minute product tour on every call, screen by screen, in the same order, regardless of what the prospect told her earlier. On a call with a school owner who cares only about fee collection reminders, Ada spends nine of her twelve minutes showing the reporting dashboard, the staff permissions screen and the mobile app icon customisation, none of which the school owner asked about. By the time she reaches the fee reminder feature, the owner has checked her phone twice.

Demo the workflow, not the software

A demo is not a tour of your product. It is a rehearsal of the prospect's own future workday, shown through your product. This distinction changes everything about how you plan one. Instead of building a fixed sequence that starts at the login screen and walks through every menu in the order your company's onboarding deck presents them, build the demo backward from the specific outcome the prospect cares about, using the exact scenario they described to you in discovery. If a school owner told you she wants to stop chasing parents for fees, your demo opens on the fee dashboard she would see on a Monday morning, not on the settings page. Every minute spent showing something unrelated to her stated problem is a minute that risks losing her attention and, worse, signals that you were not actually listening during discovery.

Whenever the platform allows it, let the prospect's own data or a close approximation of it appear on screen, and better still, let them click something themselves. People trust what they touch more than what they are shown. If you can set up the prospect's account with a sample of their own business details before the call, a small time investment that pays off heavily, the demo stops feeling like a sales presentation and starts feeling like a preview of their own future system already working. If live customisation is not possible, use a named example that closely matches their situation, for example a similar-sized school in a similar city, and say so explicitly: "This is set up exactly like a school of your size in Osogbo."

Technical glitches will happen, especially on Nigerian connections, and how you handle them matters more than whether they happen at all. A frozen screen or a slow load is not a crisis if you stay calm, narrate what should be happening while it loads, and keep the prospect's attention on the outcome rather than the delay: "While this loads, let me tell you what you are about to see, this is exactly the screen your admin staff would check every Monday morning." If a feature genuinely breaks or behaves unexpectedly, be honest rather than pretending it did not happen, briefly acknowledge it, and move forward. A prospect forgives a hiccup handled with composure far more easily than they forgive a closer who becomes visibly flustered or tries to talk over a broken screen as though nothing happened.

Break the demo into small sections, each tied to one thing the prospect said mattered, and close each section with a small confirming question before moving to the next: "Is that the kind of reminder you were picturing?" or "Would that solve the Monday morning chasing you described?" These small yeses accumulate. By the time you reach the price conversation in the next lesson, the prospect has already agreed, piece by piece, that the product solves their specific problem, which makes the final decision feel like a natural continuation rather than a leap. A demo that ends with a single "any questions?" after ten silent minutes wastes this opportunity entirely.

CASE STUDY: ADA REBUILDS HER DEMO

For her next call with a similar school owner, Ada opens directly on the fee reminder dashboard and asks the owner to name a real parent's first name so she can show a live reminder message being drafted. She skips the reporting dashboard and permissions screens entirely, since neither came up in discovery. The demo runs seven minutes instead of twelve, covers only what matters, and ends with the owner asking, unprompted, how quickly it could be set up for her school.

ROLE PLAY 16: A GLITCH DURING THE DEMO

Closer: Let me pull up the fee reminder screen for you... one moment, this is loading a little slowly today.

Prospect: Is it always like that?

Closer: Fair question, not usually, this looks like a connection hiccup on my end rather than the platform. While it loads, let me describe exactly what you are about to see: this is the screen that would automatically message any parent whose fee is overdue by three days, without you lifting a finger. There we go, it is up now. You can see it has already flagged two overdue accounts using the example we set up.

Drill. Take the pitch you wrote in Lesson 15's drill and turn it into a demo outline of no more than four screens or sections, each tied to a specific thing the prospect said. Write one confirming question to close each section. Practise narrating through a five-second pause as if the screen had frozen.

Common mistakes. Running the same fixed tour on every call. Showing features nobody asked about. Panicking visibly during a glitch. Never letting the prospect click anything. Ending without small confirming questions along the way.

Self check. Explain why demoing "the prospect's own workday" beats demoing "the product."

Price and Value Framing

By the end of this lesson you can:

- State a price calmly, clearly and without apology.
- Frame price against the cost of the problem, not against a competitor's number.
- Use anchoring and payment structure honestly.
- Handle the silence that follows stating a price.

Femi has closed the discovery and the demo perfectly, and the prospect has agreed at every check-in. When it is time to state the price, Femi's voice drops, he speaks quickly, and he adds, "but we can probably do something about that," before the prospect has even reacted. The prospect, who had shown no resistance at all until that moment, now senses hesitation and asks for a discount immediately.

How you say the number matters as much as the number

Amaka's case study in Lesson 2 already showed the pattern: a closer who states price quietly and quickly, as if apologising for it, teaches the prospect to treat the price as negotiable before any objection has even been raised. The fix is not a different number, it is a different delivery. State the price at the same pace, volume and confidence you used for the rest of the call, then stop talking. Do not soften it with a nervous laugh, do not immediately follow it with a discount offer, and do not fill the silence that comes after. This is one of the hardest habits to build because silence after a number feels unbearable to a new closer, but that silence is where the prospect processes the number against everything you built together in Lessons 13 through 16, and interrupting it robs them of that processing time.

Price should always be framed against the cost of the problem you uncovered together in the implication questions, never against a competitor's number and never apologised for by comparing it to something unrelated and cheaper. If the prospect calculated in Lesson 13 that their problem costs roughly ₦280,000 a month, and your product costs ₦45,000 a month, you do not need to argue that your price is low in the abstract, you simply need to let the two numbers sit beside each other: "So the tool is ₦45,000 a month, against the roughly ₦280,000 a month you said this problem is currently costing you." You are not inventing a comparison, you are reminding them of the comparison they already built themselves, which is far more persuasive than any argument you could construct on your own.

Anchoring is a legitimate and honest tool when it reflects real information rather than an invented reference point. If your product genuinely has a higher standard list price and the prospect is being offered a real, time-limited cohort or launch price, stating both numbers accurately, as covered under the ethical use of scarcity in Lesson 5, helps the prospect see genuine value. What is not honest is inventing a fake "normal price" that never actually applied to anyone, purely to make the real price look smaller by comparison. Payment structure can also reduce friction without reducing the honesty of your offer: if your company genuinely allows instalments, mention that option clearly, especially for Nigerian buyers who, as covered in Lesson 5's discussion of trust after being cheated, often prefer a smaller first payment over a single large one to a new vendor.

After stating the price and allowing the silence, the prospect's response tells you which branch of the Decision Tree you are now on. A clear yes moves you toward Node 9 and Lesson 21's closing techniques. A question about payment structure or start date is a buying signal, not an objection, and should be answered directly and warmly. A hesitation, a long pause, or a direct concern about the number is the beginning of Node 8, and Lessons 18 and 19 give you the full framework for handling it. The one response that should never happen is you speaking first to rescue the prospect from their own silence. Let them be the one to break it.

CASE STUDY: FEMI'S FIX

On his next call, after a strong demo, Femi states the price in the same calm tone he used throughout the call: "The investment is forty-five thousand naira a month." He then closes his mouth and waits. The silence lasts eleven seconds, which feels far longer than it sounds. The prospect finally says, "Okay, and can I start with a smaller batch of parents first to test it?" What Femi had assumed would be a price objection was simply a practical question, and he only heard it clearly because he did not talk over the silence.

ROLE PLAY 17: STATING THE PRICE AND HOLDING SILENCE

Closer: So bringing it all together, the investment for the full package is one hundred and twenty thousand naira a month, and given what you told me this problem is currently costing you, roughly two hundred and fifty thousand naira a month in lost bookings, that is the number we are looking at.

[Closer stops talking completely. Silence for several seconds.]

Prospect: Okay... that is actually less than I expected, given everything it does. Can we start next week?

Drill. Write out your price statement for a product of your choice, including a one-sentence reference back to the prospect's own cost figure from an earlier lesson. Practise saying it and then counting silently to ten in your head without speaking, even if it feels uncomfortable. Record yourself and check whether your voice speeds up or drops in volume on the number.

Common mistakes. Rushing or dropping volume on the price. Offering a discount before any objection is raised. Comparing price to a fake "normal price." Speaking to fill the silence after stating the number.

Self check. Explain why silence after stating the price works in the prospect's favour, not just yours.

PART 6

Objections and Closing

Reading resistance correctly, answering it honestly, and asking for the decision with confidence.

The Objection Map: Reading Resistance at Node 8

By the end of this lesson you can:

- Sort any objection into one of four families before answering it.
- Use acknowledge, clarify, answer, re-check as a universal response pattern.
- Tell a real objection apart from a smokescreen.
- Avoid arguing with a prospect even when they are factually wrong.

Grace hears a prospect say, "I need to think about it," and launches into a five-minute rebuttal about the product's return on investment, quoting statistics and comparing it to three competitors. The prospect grows quiet and eventually says, "I will get back to you." Grace treated a vague statement as a specific objection and answered a question the prospect never actually asked.

Not every objection is the same objection

Node 8 of the Decision Tree exists because resistance is normal and even healthy, it is a sign the prospect is taking the decision seriously rather than agreeing carelessly. The mistake most new closers make is treating every objection the same way, usually by arguing harder, when in fact objections fall into distinct families that each require a different response. Broadly, you will meet four kinds: price objections, where the number itself feels too high; trust objections, where the prospect doubts the product, the company or you specifically; timing objections, where they believe the idea is right but now is wrong; and stalls, vague delay statements that hide a real objection the prospect has not stated, often because they do not fully trust you yet or have not fully worked out the real reason themselves.

Before you can answer well, you must correctly identify which family you are in, and this requires listening for what is actually said rather than what you fear was meant. "It's a bit expensive" is a price objection. "How do I know this actually works?" is a trust objection. "We are mid-way through a big project right now" is a timing objection. "Let me think about it" or "I need to discuss with my team" without further detail is very often a stall, meaning the true objection is still hidden beneath it, and Lesson 20 gives you the specific tools to gently surface what a stall is really protecting. Answering a stall as though it were a fully formed price objection, the way Grace did in the opening story, means you are arguing against a concern the prospect never actually raised, which tends to make them retreat further rather than open up.

Whatever family an objection belongs to, a single four-step pattern handles it respectfully: acknowledge, clarify, answer, re-check. Acknowledge means you validate the concern without agreeing or disagreeing yet, something as simple as "That makes sense" or "I appreciate you being direct with me." Clarify means you ask a short question to make sure you understand the real shape of the concern before responding, since two people can say "it's expensive" and mean entirely different things, one comparing it to a much cheaper competitor, another simply not yet convinced of the value. Answer means you respond directly and honestly to the clarified concern, using the tools from Lessons 19 and 20 depending on the family. Re-check means you confirm the answer actually landed before moving forward: "Does that address it?" Skipping the re-check step is common and costly, because a closer can deliver a technically excellent answer that the prospect did not actually absorb or believe, and pressing on to close without checking simply buries the objection rather than resolving it.

A final and important discipline: never argue with a prospect, even when you are certain they are factually wrong. Arguing, no matter how correct your facts, creates a winner and a loser in the conversation, and a prospect who loses an argument rarely then hands you their money, because doing so would feel like losing twice. If a prospect states something inaccurate about your product or your industry, use the acknowledge and clarify steps to gently surface the misunderstanding as a question rather than a correction: "That's interesting, can I ask where that came from?" This usually reveals the source of the confusion, often something a competitor said or an old experience with a different vendor, and lets you address the real issue without ever putting the prospect in the position of having been wrong in front of you.

Family	Sounds like	Handled in
Price	"It's expensive" / "That's more than I budgeted"	Lesson 19
Trust	"How do I know this works?" / "I've been burned before"	Lesson 5, reinforced here
Timing	"Not right now" / "We're mid-project"	Lesson 20
Stall	"Let me think about it" / "I'll get back to you"	Lesson 20

CASE STUDY: GRACE SLOWS DOWN

On her next call the same phrase arrives: "I need to think about it." Instead of pitching harder, Grace says, "Of course, that's a fair thing to want to do.

Can I ask, is there a specific part you're still weighing, whether it's the price, the timing, or something about how it works?" The prospect pauses and admits, "Honestly, I'm just not sure my staff will actually use it." That is a trust and adoption concern entirely different from what Grace would have guessed, and now she can actually address it.

ROLE PLAY 18: ACKNOWLEDGE, CLARIFY, ANSWER, RE-CHECK

Prospect: It sounds good, but I need to think about it.

Closer: That makes complete sense, this isn't a small decision. Can I ask what specifically you'd want to think through, is it the price, the timing, or something else?

Prospect: Honestly, I'm worried my staff won't actually use something new.

Closer: That's a really fair concern, and it's actually the most common one I hear. Here's how other businesses your size have handled the rollout... [answer]. Does that ease that worry, or is there more to it?

Drill. Write down five objections you have heard or imagine hearing. Sort each into one of the four families. For one of them, write out the full acknowledge, clarify, answer, re-check sequence and practise it aloud with a partner who is instructed to give a vague first answer that requires clarifying.

Common mistakes. Answering a stall as if it were a specific objection. Arguing facts instead of clarifying. Skipping the re-check step. Treating every objection as a price objection by default.

Self check. Name the four objection families and the four-step response pattern from memory.

Price and Money Objections

By the end of this lesson you can:

- Distinguish "too expensive" from "not yet convinced of the value."
- Reframe price against cost of inaction, not against a cheaper alternative.
- Offer honest payment flexibility without discounting the core value.
- Hold your ground without sounding defensive.

A prospect tells Tayo, "Your competitor charges half of that." Tayo immediately offers a twenty percent discount to close the gap, without asking a single clarifying question first. The prospect takes the discount, signs, and cancels within six weeks, because the actual issue was never the price, it was that Tayo's product does something the cheaper competitor cannot do, and Tayo never got the chance to explain that.

Price objections are rarely only about the number

When a prospect says a price is too high, the honest first move, following the pattern from Lesson 18, is to clarify rather than react. "Too expensive" can mean the number genuinely exceeds their available budget, in which case a payment plan or a smaller starting package may be the real answer. It can mean they have not yet connected the price to a value large enough to justify it, in which case the answer is to return to the implication and need-payoff numbers from Lesson 13, not to lower the price. It can also mean, as in Tayo's case, that they are comparing your price to a different, cheaper product that does not actually solve the same problem, in which case the answer is to clarify what that alternative does and does not do, not to match its price. Discounting before understanding which of these is true almost always solves the wrong problem.

The strongest honest reframe compares your price not to a competitor but to the cost of the problem continuing, using the prospect's own numbers from earlier in the call, exactly as covered in Lesson 17's price framing. "You mentioned this is currently costing you around two hundred and fifty thousand naira a month. The tool is forty-five thousand a month. Even if it only solved part of that problem, it would still be a strong return." This is not a trick, it is arithmetic the prospect already agreed to earlier in the call, and returning to it here is simply reminding them of their own reasoning rather than inventing new pressure.

When budget genuinely is the constraint, honest flexibility can help without cheapening the offer. If your company allows instalments, a smaller starter tier, or a delayed start date to align with their next budget cycle, offer these clearly rather than defaulting to a blanket discount on the full price, which teaches every future prospect that your stated price is never the real price. A payment structure changes when and how someone pays without changing what the product is worth, while a discount changes the value itself, and the two should not be confused. If your company genuinely has no flexibility to offer, say so plainly rather than inventing an exception, because prospects who later discover you granted a "special" discount to someone else feel deceived, and that feeling spreads through referral networks quickly in a market as connected as Nigeria's.

Holding your ground on price without sounding defensive requires calm, not stubbornness. If, after clarifying and reframing honestly, the prospect still cannot afford the product, that is a legitimate outcome, not a failure of your technique, and Node 6's honest exit paths apply: perhaps a smaller package exists, perhaps this is a "not yet" to revisit in three months once their situation changes, or perhaps this genuinely is not the right fit at this time. Forcing a sale onto someone who cannot truly afford it produces exactly the churn and reputational cost warned about throughout Lessons 6 and 14, and a professional closer is willing to lose a sale rather than create a customer who resents the purchase within weeks.

CASE STUDY: TAYO'S SECOND ATTEMPT

With a different prospect making a similar comparison, Tayo pauses before offering anything. "Can I ask what that other option includes, so I understand what we're comparing?" The prospect describes a much more basic tool with no automated reminders. Tayo says, "That makes sense why the price differs, that tool doesn't include the automated part you told me was the actual reason you started looking for something new. Given that the manual chasing was costing you the time you described, does the comparison still feel fair, or would it help to look at a smaller package of just the reminder feature to start?" The prospect chooses the smaller package at full price rather than a discount.

ROLE PLAY 19: COMPARING TO A CHEAPER COMPETITOR

Prospect: Honestly, another company quoted me half this price.

Closer: That's useful to know, can I ask what's included in their offer?

Prospect: It's more basic, I think, just a messaging tool.

Closer: That's helpful context, thank you. The reason ours costs more is the automated reminder system you said was the actual reason you started looking, that part alone you estimated was worth around two hundred and fifty thousand a month to fix. Does the comparison still feel unfair once that's accounted for, or should we look at a smaller starting package?

Drill. Write three different possible meanings behind "it's too expensive" for your product, and one clarifying question and one honest response for each. Practise holding a calm, unhurried tone throughout, even when your partner pushes back twice in a row.

Common mistakes. Discounting before clarifying. Comparing your price to a competitor's price instead of to the cost of the problem. Inventing a "special" discount that is not real. Sounding defensive or irritated when price is raised.

Self check. Name three different real meanings behind "too expensive" and how your response would differ for each.

Timing, Stalls and "I Need to Consult Someone"

By the end of this lesson you can:

- Gently surface the real reason behind a vague stall.
- Respond to a genuine consultation need without treating it as an excuse.
- Include a spouse, partner or colleague in the decision process constructively.
- Set a specific follow-up date rather than accepting an open-ended delay.

A prospect tells Amara, "Let me discuss it with my husband and get back to you." Amara has heard this phrase end in silence more times than she can count, so she says, a little too quickly, "Of course, just message me whenever." Two weeks later, nothing. She had treated a legitimate cultural reality, discussed in Lesson 5, as a polite excuse to be brushed past rather than a real step to be supported.

A stall is a locked door, not a closed one

"Let me think about it" and its many cousins are, as Lesson 18 established, usually stalls rather than fully formed objections, meaning the real concern has not yet been named, sometimes because the prospect has not fully identified it themselves. The instinct to simply accept the stall and move on, as Amara did, feels respectful in the moment but almost always ends the deal quietly, because "I'll get back to you" carries no commitment and easily becomes the path of least resistance for a prospect who is not fully sure. The better instinct is to gently open the locked door, using the acknowledge and clarify steps from Lesson 18: "Totally understand. Just so I can be useful rather than just waiting, is there a specific part of this you're still turning over, so I can make sure you have everything you need?" This is not pressure, it is an offer of help framed as a question.

Genuine consultation, as opposed to a vague stall, is different and deserves a different response entirely. As Lesson 5 explained, many important Nigerian decisions are properly and honestly made together with a spouse, business partner, pastor or trusted advisor, and a closer who treats this as an obstacle to overcome rather than a normal and respectable part of the decision process will damage trust rather than build it. When a prospect says clearly that they need to discuss with a specific named person, the professional response is to support that process rather than resist it: "That makes complete sense, a decision like this should involve them. Would it help if the three of us spoke together, even briefly, so I can answer any questions they have directly, rather than the information passing through a second conversation?" Offering to join, rather than being excluded from, the real decision-making conversation dramatically increases the odds the deal survives that conversation intact.

Whether the delay is a stall being gently opened or a genuine consultation being supported, the conversation should never end without a specific next step and a specific date, never an open-ended "I'll follow up." An open promise to follow up sometime allows both people to quietly avoid the topic, while a specific commitment creates a natural, expected touchpoint: "That sounds good. Since you'll be speaking with him this weekend, would it work if I called you Monday afternoon around four, so we can pick this up while it's still fresh?" Getting a yes to a specific time, even a tentative one, is itself a small commitment that keeps the deal alive and gives you Lesson 9's rebooking tools to fall back on if the call is missed.

A final honest distinction matters here: some stalls, even after gentle probing, genuinely resolve into "not now, but maybe later," and that is a legitimate outcome to accept gracefully rather than push against repeatedly. The goal of this lesson is not to eliminate every delay through clever technique, which would edge back toward the manipulative pressure this book has warned against since Lesson 6. The goal is to make sure that when a delay is real, it is handled with a clear next step, and when a delay is actually hiding an answerable concern, that concern gets a fair chance to be heard and addressed rather than being quietly buried under politeness on both sides.

CASE STUDY: AMARA'S SECOND ATTEMPT

With a different prospect, the same phrase arrives: "Let me speak to my husband." This time Amara responds warmly: "Of course, that's exactly the right thing to do together. Would it be helpful if I sent a short one-page summary tonight with the numbers we discussed, so he has everything clearly in front of him rather than hearing it secondhand? And when do you think you'll get a chance to talk, would Monday work for a quick follow-up call?" The prospect agrees to both. The written summary gives the husband real information rather than a vague retelling, and the Monday call happens as planned.

ROLE PLAY 20: SUPPORTING A GENUINE CONSULTATION

Prospect: This all sounds good, but I really do need to talk to my business partner before anything.

Closer: Of course, a decision like this should absolutely involve them. Would it help if the three of us had a short fifteen-minute call so I can answer their questions directly, or would you prefer I send over a written summary first for you to share?

Prospect: A written summary would be good, then maybe a call after.

Closer: Perfect, I'll send that tonight. Should we pencil in Thursday afternoon for the follow-up call, just tentatively?

Drill. Write your own gentle door-opening question for a vague stall, and a separate, warmer response for a genuine named-person consultation. Practise both, then practise ending each role play with a specific day and time proposed, never an open "I'll follow up."

Common mistakes. Accepting a stall at face value without gently probing. Treating genuine consultation as an excuse to overcome. Ending on an open-ended "whenever suits you." Failing to offer a written summary or joint call to support the real decision conversation.

Self check. Explain the difference between how you would handle a vague stall versus a genuine named consultation.

The Close: Asking for the Decision

By the end of this lesson you can:

- Ask directly for a decision without hinting or hoping.
- Use trial closes throughout the call rather than only at the end.
- Handle each of the three outcomes at Node 9 professionally.
- Avoid manipulative closing tricks while still being direct.

Ola runs a flawless call. Discovery was deep, the pitch was tailored, the price landed well, and two objections were handled cleanly. At the end, instead of asking for the decision, Ola says, "So, yeah, let me know what you think," and the call ends. Three days later there has been no reply. Every skill in this book led to one final moment, and Ola did not actually ask.

Asking is not optional, and it is not rude

Node 9 of the Decision Tree is the moment everything else has been building toward, and it is astonishing how often a well-run call falls apart here simply because the closer never clearly asks for the decision. Many new closers, particularly those raised in a culture that values humility and indirectness, feel that asking directly is pushy or presumptuous, and so they soften the moment into vagueness, exactly as Ola did. But a direct ask, delivered warmly and without pressure, is not rude, it is respectful, because it gives the prospect a clear, specific choice to respond to rather than leaving them to guess what happens next or to take on the awkward job of initiating the next step themselves. "Would you like to move forward with this?" is a complete sentence that deserves to be said out loud, clearly, at the end of a call where the prospect has already indicated interest throughout.

Trial closes are smaller, lower-stakes versions of this same direct question, used throughout the call rather than saved for the very end, and they serve as an early warning system. A trial close might sound like, "If we could solve the weekend delivery issue the way we've discussed, is this something you'd want to move forward with?" asked partway through the pitch, well before the price has even been stated. A prospect's answer tells you where you stand. An enthusiastic yes tells you to keep going with confidence. A hesitant or qualified answer tells you there is an unaddressed concern still sitting beneath the surface, and it is far better to surface it now, mid-call, than to discover it only at the final ask when it is harder to unpack.

At the actual close, three outcomes are possible, and each has a professional response. A clear yes should be met with genuine warmth and immediate, concrete next steps: confirm payment method, confirm start date, thank them sincerely, and move quickly into onboarding language so the decision feels solid rather than left hanging. A "not yet," whether it emerged as a genuine timing issue from Lesson 20 or a stall that was only partially resolved, should be met exactly as that lesson described, with a specific next date rather than an open promise. A clear no should be met with grace, not desperation, a sincere thank you for their time and honesty, and, where appropriate, one honest question: "Can I ask what made this not the right fit, so I understand better?" A no delivered with grace often keeps the relationship warm enough for a referral or a future conversation, while a no met with visible disappointment or a last-ditch pressure tactic usually closes that door permanently.

This lesson deliberately does not teach manipulative closing tricks, the kind found in some older sales training that relies on false urgency, guilt, or confusing the prospect into agreement, sometimes listed under names like the "assumptive close" pushed past a genuine objection or the "take-away close" used dishonestly. These tactics violate the honesty principles established in Lesson 6, and in a market as connected as Nigeria's, where word travels fast through family, church and WhatsApp groups, a reputation for pressure tactics destroys far more future business than any single closed deal is worth. Directness and honesty, asked clearly and without fear, remain the most effective and the most sustainable way to close.

CASE STUDY: OLA'S DIRECT ASK

On the next call, after handling the final objection cleanly, Ola pauses and says, "It sounds like this solves exactly what you described. Would you like to move forward and get started this week?" The prospect says yes immediately. Ola confirms the payment method, sets the onboarding date for two days later, and thanks her warmly. The entire close takes forty seconds, because everything before it had already done the real work.

ROLE PLAY 21: TRIAL CLOSE AND FINAL ASK

Closer (mid-pitch, trial close): If this could solve the overnight message issue the way we've discussed, is this something you'd want to move forward with?

Prospect: Yes, definitely, if it works the way you're describing.

Closer (later, final ask): Based on everything we've covered, would you like to go ahead and get started this week?

Prospect: Yes, let's do it.

Closer: Wonderful. Let's confirm the payment method and I'll get you set up right away.

Drill. Write two trial close questions to use at different points in a call, and your final direct ask. Role play all three outcomes, yes, not yet, and no, with a partner, practising a warm and professional response to each without any script deviation into pressure tactics.

Common mistakes. Ending a call without a clear, direct ask. Softening the ask into vagueness. Using manipulative pressure tactics. Reacting to a no with visible disappointment or desperation.

Self check. Say your direct final ask out loud, and describe your planned response to each of the three possible outcomes.

PART 7

After the Call

The revenue producing work that happens after the video window closes: follow-up, reviving dead leads, referrals and upsells.

Follow-Up Systems and CRM Discipline

By the end of this lesson you can:

- Build a follow-up cadence that never lets a lead go silently cold.
- Write follow-up messages that add value rather than just "checking in."
- Keep CRM records clean enough that any teammate could pick up your pipeline.
- Know when to stop following up and archive a lead gracefully.

Kene closes eight deals in her first month and feels proud, but her manager pulls a report showing forty-one leads from that same month with no recorded follow-up at all after the first call, most marked only "spoke, will decide." Some of those forty-one had shown real interest. They simply disappeared into silence because nothing in Kene's system prompted her to reach back out.

The sale is rarely won on the first call alone

Lesson 7 introduced the follow-up block as one of the four daily activity blocks, and this lesson goes deeper into what should actually happen inside it. In technology sales, and especially for anything above a very small ticket size, a meaningful share of eventual customers do not buy on the first call, even when that call went well, simply because people need time to process, consult others as discussed in Lesson 20, or wait for the right moment in their own cash flow. A closer who treats the first call as the only chance and lets every "not yet" quietly vanish is leaving a significant portion of achievable revenue on the table, revenue that a disciplined follow-up system would have captured with very little additional effort.

A good follow-up cadence is planned in advance, not improvised lead by lead from memory. A simple, reliable structure is: a same-day thank-you message summarising what was discussed and confirming any agreed next step, a follow-up three days later if no response, another at seven days, another at fourteen days, and then a shift into a slower monthly check-in for leads that are genuinely "not now" rather than lost. Each touch should have a clear trigger date recorded in your CRM, discussed further below, so that following up never depends on you remembering, only on you checking your list. Brian Choi's emphasis on filling downtime with revenue producing activity, referenced in Lesson 2 and Lesson 7, applies directly here: a scheduled follow-up block is exactly this kind of activity, converting spare time into real pipeline movement rather than idle waiting for new bookings.

The content of a follow-up message matters as much as its timing. A message that simply says "just checking in, any update?" asks the prospect to do work, to remember the whole conversation and formulate a response, and most people will keep postponing that effort indefinitely. A stronger follow-up adds something new each time: a relevant customer story similar to their situation, an answer to a question they raised but you did not fully address on the call, a short piece of useful information unrelated to selling, or a direct, specific question that is easy to answer, such as "Did you get a chance to speak with your partner, or would it help to set a specific time this week?" Each message should feel like it was written for that specific person, referencing the details from your Node 2 through 6 notes from Lesson 10, not a generic template copied across every lead.

CRM discipline, first introduced in Lesson 3, is what makes all of this sustainable at scale. Every lead record should show, at a glance, their current stage, the date and content of the last contact, the specific next action and its exact date, and a short note capturing their stated problem and cost from discovery, so that any teammate, or you yourself three weeks later, could pick up the thread without confusion. Leads that have received the full cadence without response should not simply vanish from view, they should be explicitly marked and archived into a long-term nurture list rather than deleted, because circumstances change, and a lead gone quiet in March may have a real budget and a real problem again in September. A clean, current CRM is not paperwork for its own sake, it is the memory of your entire pipeline, and a pipeline nobody can see clearly is a pipeline that quietly leaks.

CASE STUDY: KENE'S REBUILT CADENCE

Kene builds the five-touch cadence into her calendar with automatic reminders and updates her CRM notes to include the specific problem and cost figure from each call. Over the following month she works through her backlog of forty-one silent leads using the new message style, referencing each person's specific situation. Nine respond, four of those move forward to a second call, and two close, entirely from leads she had previously written off as lost.

ROLE PLAY 22: A VALUE-ADDING FOLLOW-UP MESSAGE

Closer (message, day 7): Hi Mrs Adeyemi, hope your week is going well. I was speaking with another school owner in Osogbo this week who had the exact same fee-chasing headache you described, and she mentioned the thing that helped most was starting with just the reminder feature before adding anything else. Might be a useful way to think about a smaller first step if that helps. Also wanted to check, did you get a chance to speak with your husband yet, or would a quick fifteen-minute call this week with all three of us make sense?

Drill. Build your five-touch follow-up cadence with exact day intervals. Write the full text of the day-three and day-seven messages for a lead from an earlier lesson's role play, making sure each adds something new rather than just asking for an update. Set up your CRM's next-action field for that same lead.

Common mistakes. Letting leads go silent after one call. Sending generic "just checking in" messages. Keeping CRM notes too thin for anyone else to use. Deleting cold leads instead of archiving them for future nurture.

Self check. Recite your five-touch cadence intervals and describe what makes a follow-up message add value rather than just ask for one.

Reviving Dead Leads, Asking for Referrals, and Upselling

By the end of this lesson you can:

- Reopen a lead that went cold months ago without sounding desperate.
- Ask for referrals at the right moment using a specific, easy-to-answer script.
- Recognise and act on natural upsell moments with existing customers.
- Treat these three activities as core, scheduled work rather than occasional extras.

Ifeanyi has a spreadsheet tab labelled "dead" with ninety-three names he has not touched in over four months. He also has eleven happy, active customers he has never once asked for a referral, and three of those customers have recently grown their teams in ways that would clearly benefit from a bigger package he has never mentioned. All three of these are sitting revenue that Ifeanyi has simply never gone back to collect.

Three activities that cost almost nothing and produce real revenue

These three activities, reviving dead leads, asking for referrals, and upselling existing customers, sit at the centre of the revenue producing activities Brian Choi describes doing during downtime rather than waiting idly for the next booking, as covered first in Lesson 2 and applied throughout Lesson 7's daily system. What unites them is that each targets people who already know something about you or your product, which makes them dramatically less expensive to reach than a brand-new cold lead, and yet most closers, like Ifeanyi, systematically neglect all three in favour of chasing fresh bookings, simply because fresh bookings feel more exciting even when they are far more expensive to win.

Reviving a dead lead requires a specific kind of message, one that acknowledges the time gap honestly rather than pretending the silence never happened, and that gives the prospect a real, current reason to re-engage rather than simply repeating the old pitch. "It's been a few months since we last spoke about the overnight message problem, I don't want to assume it's still relevant, but I wanted to check in, has anything changed on your end, or is this still something you'd want to solve?" This kind of message respects that circumstances shift, invites an honest update rather than a sales pitch, and often surfaces genuinely new information, a busy season has passed, a budget has freed up, a competitor's failure has made the problem newly painful. A batch of thirty dead leads reactivated with a message like this, worked through steadily during a slow week as Choi's activity-focused approach suggests, regularly produces several real new conversations at almost no cost beyond the time spent writing and sending.

Referrals were introduced briefly in Lesson 8, and the discipline of asking is worth returning to here as a scheduled, repeated habit rather than a one-time idea. The right moment is immediately after a customer experiences a genuine win, a moment of gratitude and goodwill that fades quickly if not used. The right script is specific rather than vague, as Lesson 8 established: not "do you know anyone," but "who is one other person you know in a similar situation who might have the same problem you had?" Make the ask easy to act on by offering to write the introduction message yourself for the customer to simply forward, removing the small effort barrier that otherwise causes even a willing customer to quietly never follow through.

Upselling means recognising when an existing customer's situation has genuinely grown or changed in a way that makes a bigger or additional offering a real fit, not a forced add-on pushed for the sake of extra revenue. A school that started with the basic fee reminder tool and has since doubled its student count may now genuinely benefit from the reporting dashboard Ada learned to leave out of early demos in Lesson 16, precisely because it was not yet relevant, but is relevant now. The approach mirrors the honest, discovery-led method used throughout this book: check in on how they are using the product, listen for a new problem or growing pain, and only then present the relevant next step, using the same three-part pitch structure from Lesson 15 rather than a generic renewal email. Treated this way, an upsell conversation is simply a second, smaller version of the entire Decision Tree, applied to a person who already trusts you.

CASE STUDY: IFEANYI WORKS HIS THREE LISTS

During one slow week with few bookings, Ifeanyi spends his follow-up blocks working through fifteen dead leads with honest reopening messages, asking all eleven active customers for a specific referral, and checking in on the three customers he suspected had outgrown their current package. By the end of the week: four dead leads restart real conversations, six customers send referral introductions producing three new booked calls, and one customer confirms interest in upgrading. None of this required a single new advertising naira.

ROLE PLAY 23: THE SPECIFIC REFERRAL ASK

Closer: I'm really glad this has made such a difference for your fee collection. Can I ask you something? Who's one other school owner you know, maybe someone you've talked to about this exact headache before, who might be dealing with the same thing?

Prospect: Actually, my friend Funke runs a school in Ojo and complains about this constantly.

Closer: Would it be alright if I wrote a short message you could forward to her, just to make it easy? Or would you rather I reach out directly and mention your name?

Prospect: Send me the message, I'll forward it.

Drill. Pull three "dead" leads from any earlier lesson's practice notes and write a specific reopening message for each. Write your standard referral ask script and your standard upsell check-in question. Schedule one full follow-up block this week dedicated entirely to these three activities rather than new outreach.

Common mistakes. Treating dead leads as permanently gone. Never asking existing happy customers for referrals. Forcing an upsell that does not genuinely fit the customer's current situation. Doing these activities only occasionally instead of on a scheduled cadence.

Self check. Name the three activities in this lesson and explain why each is cheaper than winning a brand-new cold lead.

PART 8

Going Professional

Measuring yourself honestly, getting hired, understanding your pay, and your first thirty days as a working closer.

Metrics and Self Call Review

By the end of this lesson you can:

- Track the core pipeline numbers that tell you where you are actually losing deals.
- Score your own recorded calls against a simple rubric.
- Turn one weak pattern per week into a specific, practised fix.
- Avoid the two opposite traps of ignoring numbers and obsessing over them.

Musa has taken over two hundred calls in his first three months and genuinely believes he is improving, because each call feels more comfortable than the last. When his manager asks for his actual close rate broken down by objection type, Musa has no answer. He has been practising, but without measurement he has no way to know whether his comfort reflects real skill growth or simply familiarity with being on a call.

Comfort is not the same as improvement

Lesson 7 introduced pipeline arithmetic and the idea of knowing your numbers at each stage. This lesson turns that idea into a weekly habit of measurement and review that should continue for the rest of your career, not just during training. The core numbers worth tracking every week are simple and few: how many calls you took, your show rate from Lesson 9, how many of those calls were genuinely qualified per the Node 6 criteria from Lesson 14, how many objections you faced broken down by the four families from Lesson 18, and how many closed. These numbers, tracked consistently, reveal patterns invisible from the inside of any single call, exactly the way Amaka's spreadsheet in Lesson 2 revealed that most of her losses happened specifically after the price was stated, a pattern she could never have noticed just by feeling generally that calls "went okay."

Self call review is the second half of this discipline, and it should happen on a recording, never from memory alone, because memory during a live call is occupied with listening and responding, not evaluating your own performance. Choose one call per week, ideally one that did not close, and listen to it in full with a simple rubric in front of you covering the major sections of this book: did the opening in Lesson 11 set a clear frame, did discovery in Lessons 12 and 13 reach real implication and need-payoff depth, was the pitch in Lesson 15 built from the prospect's actual words, was the price in Lesson 17 stated with confidence and followed by real silence, and was any objection in Lessons 18 through 20 met with the full acknowledge, clarify, answer, re-check pattern rather than a rushed reaction. Score each section honestly on a simple scale, and resist the urge to only review calls that went well, since a call that failed almost always teaches more than one that succeeded for reasons you may not fully understand.

The purpose of this weekly review is not general self-criticism, which tends to produce vague discouragement rather than improvement. The purpose is to identify exactly one specific, narrow pattern each week and turn it into a deliberately practised fix before moving to the next call. If your review reveals that you consistently skip the implication questions from Lesson 13 and jump straight from problem to pitch, your fix for that week is not "improve discovery" in general, it is "ask at least two implication questions on every call this week, and note in your CRM whether you did." This narrow, specific, trackable approach mirrors what separates a beginner who practises randomly from a professional who trains deliberately, one skill at a time, with clear evidence of whether the fix actually took hold.

Two opposite traps deserve a warning here. The first trap is ignoring numbers entirely and relying purely on how a call felt, Musa's mistake, which leaves you blind to real patterns and unable to explain your own performance to a manager or to yourself. The second, less obvious trap is becoming so obsessed with tracking and scoring that you lose the natural, human presence that makes discovery questions land authentically, turning every call into an anxious performance for an invisible scorecard rather than a genuine conversation. The goal is a light, weekly discipline, thirty minutes of honest review, one specific fix identified, one week of deliberate practice on that fix, and then back to full attention on the person in front of you during the actual call itself.

Weekly metric	Why it matters
Calls taken	Raw activity volume from Lesson 7
Show rate	Reminder system effectiveness from Lesson 9
Qualified rate	Whether Node 6 fit criteria are being applied honestly
Objections by family	Which of the four families from Lesson 18 appears most, revealing where to sharpen skill
Close rate on qualified calls	The number that most directly reflects your actual selling skill

CASE STUDY: MUSA STARTS MEASURING

Musa begins tracking his five weekly numbers and reviewing one lost call each Friday against the rubric. After three weeks the pattern is clear: nearly every lost call involves a price objection that he answers by immediately offering a discount, skipping Lesson 19's clarify step entirely. His one fix for

the following week is simple: on every price objection, ask one clarifying question before responding at all. By the fourth week his close rate on price-objection calls has visibly improved, and for the first time he can explain exactly why.

ROLE PLAY 24: A WEEKLY REVIEW CONVERSATION WITH A MENTOR

Mentor: What did this week's review show you?

Musa: I listened to Tuesday's lost call. I skipped the clarify step on the price objection completely and went straight to a discount.

Mentor: What's your one fix for next week?

Musa: On every price objection, I ask a clarifying question first, no exceptions, before I say anything about the number itself.

Drill. Build your own five-row weekly metrics table and fill it in for your most recent practice week, even if the numbers come from role plays rather than live calls. Record and review one call against the section-by-section rubric described above, and write down exactly one specific, narrow fix for the coming week.

Common mistakes. Judging performance only by how a call felt. Reviewing only calls that went well. Trying to fix everything at once instead of one narrow pattern. Turning every call into an anxious performance for an internal scorecard.

Self check. Name your five core weekly metrics and describe how you choose one specific weekly fix from a call review.

Applying for Remote Closer Roles: Portfolio, Interview and Red Flags

By the end of this lesson you can:

- Assemble a portfolio of proof that a stranger can trust.
- Answer common interview and trial-call questions with confidence.
- Spot the red flags of a bad opportunity, revisited from Lesson 1, in a live application process.
- Negotiate a fair trial period without underselling yourself.

Aisha has completed every lesson in this book, practised dozens of role plays, and genuinely has real skill. But when she applies for her first remote closer role, her application says only, "I am hardworking and a fast learner, please give me a chance." The hiring manager receives forty similar messages that week and has no way to tell Aisha apart from the other thirty-nine.

Proof beats promises

Lesson 1 established that a genuine employer wants evidence, not enthusiasm, because enthusiasm is free and easy to fake, while demonstrated skill is neither. By this point in the course you have built exactly the raw material for real proof: recorded role plays from nearly every lesson, a completed note template from Lesson 10, a written personal code of conduct from Lesson 6, and a working understanding of the full Decision Tree. A portfolio simply organises this material into a form a busy hiring manager can review in minutes rather than hours. At minimum, assemble two or three of your strongest recorded role plays, ideally covering a full call from opening through close, a one-page summary of the Decision Tree and how you apply it, and a short written reflection on what you have learned about ethical, non-manipulative selling, directly addressing the reputation concerns many technology companies now have about traditional high-pressure sales training.

Interview and trial-call questions for a remote closer role tend to cluster around a small number of themes, and preparing specific, concrete answers for each, rather than general enthusiasm, sets you apart immediately. Expect to be asked to explain your sales process in your own words, exactly as Ngozi practised in Lesson 1's role play, and your answer should reference the Decision Tree by name and briefly walk through its stages. Expect a question about handling a specific objection, and your answer should demonstrate the acknowledge, clarify, answer, re-check pattern from Lesson 18 rather than a memorised rebuttal. Expect a question about your experience with commission-based pay, and your honest answer, informed by Lesson 1's discussion of the slow start, should show that you understand and have planned for the income shape rather than expecting an immediate salary. Many companies will also run an actual trial call or role play as part of the interview itself, which is precisely why the practice in this book has been built around real spoken rehearsal rather than passive reading.

Red flags deserve a second, more detailed look here, now applied to the specific texture of a live application process rather than the general warning given in Lesson 1. Be cautious of any role that asks for payment before you are hired, that cannot clearly explain its product in one or two sentences, that refuses to share a written commission structure until after you accept, or that pressures you to decide within an unreasonably short window, a tactic that, ironically, mirrors exactly the manipulative urgency this book has taught you never to use on a prospect. A legitimate technology company selling a real product will usually be able to name specific customers, describe its onboarding process for new closers, and offer some form of paid trial period, because a serious employer wants to see your actual calls before committing long term, exactly as you want to see their actual pay structure before committing your time.

Negotiating a fair trial period is a skill in itself, and the same directness taught throughout Lesson 21's closing lessons applies here in reverse, with you as the one being asked to decide. It is entirely reasonable to ask, politely and directly, how many calls or weeks the trial covers, what specific criteria determine whether it becomes a longer-term role, and whether any base pay or call allowance applies during the trial period itself. Do not undersell the genuine skill you have built through this course by accepting a trial with no clear end point or evaluation criteria, since a trial without defined boundaries can quietly extend indefinitely, leaving you working real hours for uncertain, delayed pay. Asking these questions clearly, using the same calm, confident tone you have practised throughout every role play in this book, is itself a small demonstration of the professionalism you are applying to sell.

CASE STUDY: AISHA REBUILDS HER APPLICATION

Aisha rewrites her application to include a two-minute recorded role play covering a full discovery-to-close conversation, a one-paragraph explanation of the Decision Tree referencing specifically how she handles Node 6 qualification, and one direct question about the company's commission structure and trial length. The hiring manager, who normally skims applications in seconds, replies within a day asking to schedule a trial call, specifically citing the recorded role play as the reason Aisha stood out from the pile.

ROLE PLAY 25: THE TRIAL INTERVIEW

Hiring manager: Walk me through how you'd handle a prospect who says the price is too high.

Aisha: First I'd acknowledge it without agreeing or disagreeing, then ask a clarifying question, since "too expensive" can mean a few different things, a real budget limit, an

unclear sense of value, or a comparison to something that doesn't actually do the same job. Once I understand which one it is, I respond to that specific concern, often by reconnecting the price to whatever cost the prospect described earlier in the call, and then I check that the answer actually landed before moving forward.

Hiring manager: Good. And what would you want to know about our trial period before starting?

Aisha: How many calls or weeks it covers, what specific criteria you'll use to evaluate it, and whether any base pay applies during that time.

Drill. Assemble your own two-to-three-piece portfolio from recordings and notes built throughout this course. Write out full answers to the three common interview questions above. Write your three trial-period questions and practise asking them aloud in a calm, direct tone.

Common mistakes. Applying with generic enthusiasm and no proof. Accepting a role with no written commission plan. Ignoring red flags because you are eager to start. Agreeing to an open-ended trial with no defined evaluation point.

Self check. List the three pieces of your portfolio and the three questions you will ask about any trial period before accepting.

Contracts, Pay Structures and Your 30-Day Launch Plan

By the end of this lesson you can:

- Read a commission-based contract and know what to check for.
- Understand realistic options for receiving foreign payments as a Nigerian.
- Know your basic tax record-keeping obligations as a remote earner.
- Follow a concrete 30-day plan from finishing this book to your first live calls.

Success has just been offered his first remote closer role and is thrilled. The offer letter is three sentences long, states only "commission based, competitive rates," and gives no detail about payment timing, refund clawbacks, or how "closed" is defined. He is ready to sign immediately, purely out of excitement, without asking a single clarifying question.

Reading your own contract

A commission-based agreement, even an informal one sent by message rather than a formal legal document, should answer several specific questions clearly, and Success's three-sentence offer answers none of them. What exact percentage or flat amount do you earn per closed deal, and does that rate change at different volume tiers? At what point is a deal officially "closed" for commission purposes, at signing, at first payment received, or only after a refund window has passed? Are commissions clawed back if a customer cancels or requests a refund within some period, and if so, how long is that window? How and how often are you actually paid, weekly, monthly, and through what channel? None of these questions require legal training to ask, and any legitimate employer should be able to answer each one plainly, exactly as Lesson 1 established that a serious company welcomes specific questions rather than treating them as distrust.

Lesson 3 introduced the practical landscape of receiving foreign payment as a Nigerian, and it is worth reinforcing here at the point of actually starting a role. As of recent guidance, commonly used channels include Payoneer, virtual dollar accounts such as Grey and Raenest, formerly Geegpay, and, where an employer specifically uses an employer of record platform, Deel, which allows withdrawal to a Nigerian bank account. These options, their fees and their regulatory status continue to change, partly due to evolving Central Bank of Nigeria requirements for international money transfer operators, so treat any specific figures you read online, including in this book, as a starting point for your own current research rather than a fixed fact, and always prefer formal, traceable channels over informal arrangements that could leave you with no recourse if something goes wrong.

Tax record-keeping is a responsibility that catches many new remote earners by surprise, particularly given that new Nigerian tax rules taking effect from January 2026 are widely reported to bring closer scrutiny to income received through platforms such as Payoneer, which historically many freelancers treated as informal or unreported. This book cannot and does not offer tax advice, since rules vary by individual circumstance and continue to develop, but the responsible practice, regardless of the specific rules in force, is to keep clear records from your very first payment: dates, amounts, the currency and exchange rate used, and the source of each payment. Consult a qualified Nigerian tax professional once you begin earning consistently, rather than assuming informal income is automatically outside the tax system.

Your final task in this book is a concrete thirty-day plan bridging the gap between finishing these lessons and taking real, live calls with real income at stake. Days one through seven: complete a final full review of your weakest three lessons based on your self checks throughout the book, and record two full mock calls from opening to close with a practice partner. Days eight through fourteen: assemble your portfolio from Lesson 25 and begin actively applying to genuine, vetted opportunities, screening each one against the red flags from Lessons 1 and 25. Days fifteen through twenty-one: complete interviews and trial calls, negotiate trial terms clearly, and, once accepted, spend this window on intensive product learning using the 72-hour method from Lesson 4 for your specific new employer's product. Days twenty-two through thirty: take your first live calls, applying the weekly metrics and review discipline from Lesson 24 from your very first week rather than waiting until problems accumulate, and begin your follow-up, referral and revival activities from Lessons 22 and 23 as soon as you have your first handful of real leads in the system.

Days	Focus
1 to 7	Final review of weak lessons; two full mock calls recorded end to end
8 to 14	Build portfolio; apply to vetted opportunities; screen for red flags
15 to 21	Interviews and trial calls; negotiate trial terms; 72-hour product learning
22 to 30	First live calls; weekly metrics from day one; begin follow-up and referral cadence

CASE STUDY: SUCCESS ASKS BEFORE HE SIGNS

Before responding to his offer, Success sends three specific questions: what percentage commission applies at his expected volume, when exactly a deal counts as closed, and how often payments are actually made. The company responds with a clear written breakdown he had not been given initially, revealing a thirty-day refund clawback window he needs to plan his finances around. He signs with full understanding rather than blind excitement, and his first month's income planning

accounts for that clawback window from the start.

ROLE PLAY 26: CLARIFYING AN OFFER BEFORE SIGNING

Success: Thank you for the offer, I'm excited to get started. Before I sign, could you clarify a few things: what's the exact commission percentage at my expected call volume, at what point does a sale officially count as closed for commission, and roughly how often are payments made?

Employer: Fair questions. It's 12 percent, closed means payment received and past a thirty-day refund window, and we pay out on the fifteenth of each month for the previous month's closed deals.

Success: That's very helpful, thank you, that gives me a clear picture to plan around.

Drill. Write your own list of five specific questions you will ask before signing any commission-based offer. Fill in your personal thirty-day launch plan using the table above as a template, with your own specific dates starting from today. Set a calendar reminder for day thirty to review your progress against this plan honestly.

Common mistakes. Signing an offer with no clear commission or payment detail. Assuming foreign platform income is automatically untaxed. Skipping record-keeping from the first payment. Drifting through the thirty-day window without a concrete plan.

Self check. List the four contract questions from this lesson and your own thirty-day plan's four weekly focuses.

Script Library: Quick Reference

Pull these out before a live call. Each is drawn from a lesson in this book; adapt the wording to sound like you, not like a script being read.

Opening (Lesson 11)

"Good [morning/afternoon] [Name], thank you for making time. [Warm personal detail/question]. Here's how I'd like to use our time today: we have about [X] minutes, I'll ask some questions about how things work for you now, and if it looks like a fit, I'll show you how it could help. At the end you can say yes, no, or not now, and any of those is completely fine. Does that work for you? And is it alright if I take notes / record this for quality, and if I ask some direct questions about how things run today?"

Situation and problem questions (Lesson 12)

- "Walk me through what happens today when [relevant event]."
- "What tools or process do you use for that right now?"
- "What's not working as well as you'd like?"
- "What made you decide to look into this now?"
- "Tell me more about that." / "What do you mean by that?" / "How long has that been happening?"

Implication and need-payoff (Lesson 13)

- "When [problem] happens, what happens next?"
- "How often would you say that happens in a [week/month]?"
- "If that's been happening for [time period], what would you estimate that has cost you in total?"
- "If this were completely solved, what would that be worth to you?"

Qualification (Lesson 14)

- "Once you find something that looks right, what does the approval process usually look like?"
- "Besides yourself, who else would want to weigh in before this moves forward?"
- "Businesses at your stage typically invest somewhere between [X] and [Y] for something like this — does that sound like a realistic range?"

The pitch (Lesson 15)

"You told me [restate situation and problem in their words]. You mentioned that fixing this could be worth [their stated value]. What we do specifically is [1–3 features tied directly to what they said]. Does that match what you were describing?"

Stating the price (Lesson 17)

"The investment is [price], and given what you told me this is currently costing you around [their number], that's the number we're looking at." [Then stop talking completely.]

Objection response pattern (Lesson 18)

Acknowledge → "[Reflect the concern, e.g. "That makes sense" / "I appreciate you being direct"]" → Clarify → "Can I ask, is it [X] or [Y]?" → Answer → [respond to the clarified concern] → Re-check → "Does that address it?"

Price objection (Lesson 19)

"Can I ask what that's being compared to?" ... "That makes sense why the numbers differ — the reason ours costs more is [X], which you said was worth [Y] to you. Does the comparison still feel unfair once that's accounted for?"

Stalls and consultation (Lesson 20)

- "Totally understand. Just so I can be useful rather than just waiting, is there a specific part you're still turning over?"
- "That makes complete sense, a decision like this should involve them. Would it help if the three of us spoke briefly, or would you prefer I send a written summary first?"
- "Should we pencil in [specific day/time] to pick this back up?"

The close (Lesson 21)

- Trial close: "If this could solve [problem], is this something you'd want to move forward with?"
- Final ask: "Based on everything we've covered, would you like to move forward and get started this week?"
- On a no: "I completely understand, thank you for your honesty. Can I ask what made this not the right fit, so I understand better?"

Follow-up and revival (Lessons 22–23)

- Value-add follow-up: "[New useful detail relevant to them]. Also wanted to check, [specific easy question]?"
- Dead lead revival: "It's been a while since we spoke about [problem]. I don't want to assume it's still relevant, but wanted to check — has anything changed, or is this still something you'd want to solve?"
- Referral ask: "Who's one other [specific type of person] you know who might have the same problem you had?"

Glossary

Term	Meaning
Closer	The salesperson who takes an already-interested prospect through discovery, presentation and decision
Setter	The person who finds or warms leads and books the call for a closer
Decision Tree	The DSS nine-node map of a sales call, from Connect through Commit, used throughout this book
SPIN	Situation, Problem, Implication, Need-payoff — Neil Rackham's question categories
NEPQ	Neuro-Emotional Persuasion Questioning, Jeremy Miner's question-based sales method
Up-front agreement	Stating the time, plan and acceptable outcomes at the start of a call, from the Sandler method
Show rate	Percentage of booked calls that actually happen
Qualified lead	A prospect confirmed to have a real problem, the authority and ability to buy, and genuine product fit
Stall	A vague delay statement ("let me think about it") that usually hides an unstated real objection
Trial close	A small, low-stakes check for buying interest used before the final ask
Clawback	A contract term where a paid commission is reversed if the customer later cancels or refunds
SaaS	Software as a Service — software rented through a subscription rather than bought once
API	Application Programming Interface — the doorway that lets two programs share data
Hallucination	When an AI system produces a confident but factually wrong answer
NDPA	Nigeria Data Protection Act 2023, the law governing how personal data is collected and used
CRM	Customer Relationship Management — the system or spreadsheet recording leads and their status

Self-Assessment Tracker (DSS Readiness Index, Student Edition)

Score yourself honestly from 1 (not yet confident) to 5 (could teach this to someone else) after your drills for each part. Retake this every few weeks as you keep practising.

Competency	Lessons	Score (1–5)
Mindset, activity and process discipline	1–3	
Tech product literacy and honest limits	4–6	
Daily system, outreach and booking	7–9	
Discovery: situation, problem, implication, need-payoff	10–13	
Qualification and fit	14	
Pitch, demo and price framing	15–17	
Objection handling by family	18–20	
Closing directly and gracefully	21	
Follow-up, revival, referrals, upsells	22–23	
Metrics, review and professional launch	24–26	

How to use this score. Any competency below 3 is where your next week of drilling should focus. Do not move on to live paid calls, per Lesson 26’s thirty-day plan, until every row reads at least 3, and ideally until your weakest three rows have been specifically drilled with a partner, not just read again.

Sources and Further Reading

This handbook explains ideas in its own words for teaching purposes and credits the original thinkers throughout. Go to the originals for full depth.

Choi, Brian. Public profiles, interviews and course descriptions on his activity-and-process philosophy and his Real Sales System programme (Sales Elevate / Real Sales System, accessed via [brianchoi](#) and [successxl.com](#) profiles, 2024–2026). His scripts, templates and SOPs are proprietary to his paid course and are not reproduced here.

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Blount, Jeb. *Fanatical Prospecting*. Wiley, 2015. Source for the activity-discipline framing in Lesson 7.

Sandler Training. The "up-front agreement" concept referenced in Lesson 11 originates from David Sandler's sales methodology.

Nigeria Data Protection Act, 2023, and the General Application and Implementation Directive (GAID) 2025, Nigeria Data Protection Commission — referenced in Lessons 3 and 6. This book offers an educational summary only, not legal advice.

Guides on receiving foreign payments as a Nigerian remote worker or freelancer (Grey, Figo, TurnetFinance, iCesume, 2026 editions) — referenced in Lessons 3 and 26. Payment platform terms, fees and regulatory status change; verify current details directly with each provider before relying on them.

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